Matrix-free Ewald–PPPM evaluation of configuration-dependent longitudinal friction and correlated noise in a Lennard-Jones liquid

Working draft assembled from the project code and results (not for distribution)

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Abstract

We study a Langevin-type particle model in which the friction acting on the particle momenta is a dense, configuration-dependent $3N \times 3N$ matrix $\Gamma(\mathbf{q})$ built from a screened, purely longitudinal pair kernel $K(\mathbf{r}) = c\, e^{-\kappa r}\mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^{\mathsf{T}}/r^3$ summed over all periodic images, and in which the thermal noise is correlated with covariance $2k_{\mathrm{B}}T\,\Gamma(\mathbf{q})$. The conservative interaction is a smoothly truncated Lennard-Jones (LJ) potential. The goal is to keep the dynamics of this chosen model while replacing the $O(N^2)$ assembly and the $O(N^3)$ eigendecomposition of Γ by matrix-free operations. We write Γ as a weighted graph Laplacian, derive an Ewald splitting of the kernel through a Gaussian-scale representation obtained by one integration by parts, and evaluate the long-range part by a particle–particle particle–mesh (PPPM) action whose self terms cancel exactly. The O-step of a BAOAB integrator applies the exact finite-time Ornstein–Uhlenbeck map for frozen Γ, $e^{-h\Gamma/m}$ and $[k_{\mathrm{B}}Tm(\mathbf{I} - e^{-2h\Gamma/m})]^{1/2}$, through fixed-rank Lanczos approximations restricted to the zero-total-momentum subspace, so total momentum is carried exactly. For an LJ liquid at $\rho^* = 0.75$, $k_{\mathrm{B}}T = 1$, $N = 256$, the PPPM operator error relative to the full periodic lattice-sum matrix is at most 7.6×10^{-8} (spectral norm) on 152 representative and visited configurations, and the Lanczos error at ranks 14/5 is at most 6.4×10^{-10}. A coupled four-level time-step study with 16 replicas, judged against criteria fixed before the runs, validates no time step: $\mathrm{d}t = 0.005$ is a provisional choice, and $\mathrm{d}t = 0.01$ shows resolved but sub-percent biases in temperature and potential energy. Dynamical correlation functions (VACF, distance-conditioned VCCF, longitudinal and transverse current correlations, distinct van Hove function) are reported with simultaneous confidence bands; at the available sample size most 1% comparisons between time steps are undecided. We state explicitly which conclusions are verified, which are under-sampled, and which rest only on earlier test systems.

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1 Introduction

Coarse-grained particle models often replace eliminated degrees of freedom by a friction and a matching random force. When the friction couples different particles, the friction matrix $\Gamma(\mathbf{q}) \in \mathbb{R}^{3N\times 3N}$ is dense and depends on the configuration, and by the fluctuation–dissipation theorem (FDT) the noise covariance must be proportional to $\Gamma(\mathbf{q})$. Pairwise friction of dissipative-particle-dynamics type [1] has this structure with a short-ranged kernel; the observables used to characterise memory and correlated dissipation in coarse-grained liquids—the velocity autocorrelation function, distance-resolved velocity cross-correlations and hydrodynamic current correlations—are discussed, for example, by Lyu and Lei [2]. We use these observables as diagnostics only. The present model is a toy model with a prescribed kernel; it is not fitted to, and is not claimed to reproduce, the molecular system of Ref. [2].

The computational difficulty is twofold. First, a long-ranged kernel summed over periodic images makes every block of Γ nonzero, so an explicit assembly costs $O(N^2)$ memory and time per step. Second, the noise requires a matrix square root, or more precisely the finite-time function

$[k_{\mathrm{B}}Tm(\mathbf{I} - e^{-2h\Gamma/m})]^{1/2}$, whose dense evaluation costs $O(N^3)$. Ewald-type splitting and particle–mesh methods [3–7] and their tensor variants for Stokes kernels [8, 9] remove the first difficulty for matrix–vector products; Krylov methods for matrix functions [10, 11] and for correlated Brownian noise [12, 13] address the second using only such products. The organisation of this paper—a structural formulation, a matrix-free evaluator, a Krylov update, and numerical experiments ordered from spatial to temporal to observable to cost—follows that of a recent particle method for the Landau equation [14]. The physics, the integrator and the conclusions here are different: our system is thermostatted, it does not conserve kinetic energy, and we prove no weak-convergence theorem.

Contributions and scope.

1. A statement of the particle model actually implemented in the project code (Section 2): an underdamped SDE with LJ forces and a full-periodic longitudinal friction kernel whose $k = 0$ Fourier component is retained; its graph-Laplacian structure, positivity, momentum null space and FDT.

2. An Ewald splitting of the screened longitudinal kernel through a Gaussian-scale density ρ_κ obtained by one integration by parts, its Fourier coefficients, and a PPPM graph-Laplacian action with exact self-term cancellation (Section 3).

3. A BAOAB integrator whose O-step is the exact OU map for frozen $\Gamma(\mathbf{q}_{1/2})$, evaluated by fixed-rank Lanczos on the zero-momentum subspace, and an exact nested noise coupling used to compare time steps pathwise (Section 4).

4. A layered verification for one LJ state point and one kernel (kernel A): operator and Lanczos accuracy on static and visited configurations, a pre-registered time-step study, dynamical correlation functions with simultaneous bands, and measured cost (Section 5).

A second kernel ("law B"), a pair double-well potential and an earlier lower-density state point were also studied in the project. They are summarised in Appendix D and are not used for the main conclusions.

2 Particle model and structural properties

2.1 Equations of motion

Consider N particles of mass m in a cubic periodic box of side L and volume $V = L^3$, with positions $\mathbf{q} = (\mathbf{q}_1, \dots, \mathbf{q}_N)$ and momenta $\mathbf{p} = (\mathbf{p}_1, \dots, \mathbf{p}_N)$. The model is

$$\mathrm{d}\mathbf{q} = \frac{\mathbf{p}}{m}\,\mathrm{d}t, \qquad \mathrm{d}\mathbf{p} = F(\mathbf{q})\,\mathrm{d}t - \Gamma(\mathbf{q})\frac{\mathbf{p}}{m}\,\mathrm{d}t + \sqrt{2k_{\mathrm{B}}T}\,\Gamma(\mathbf{q})^{1/2}\,\mathrm{d}W_t, \tag{1}$$

where W_t is a standard Wiener process in $\mathbb{R}^{3N}$. Equation (1) is the continuous-time model whose O-step is integrated exactly in Section 4; the code implements the discrete scheme, not (1) directly.

Conservative force. $F = -\nabla U$, $U(\mathbf{q}) = \sum_{i<j} u(r_{ij})$, with $r_{ij} = |\mathbf{q}_i - \mathbf{q}_j|$ under the minimum-image convention and

$$\begin{aligned} u(r) &= S(r)\,4\varepsilon\Big[\Big(\frac{\sigma}{r}\Big)^{12} - \Big(\frac{\sigma}{r}\Big)^{6}\Big], \\ S(r) &= 1 - 10x^3 + 15x^4 - 6x^5, \quad x = \min\Big\{1, \max\Big\{0, \frac{r/\sigma - r_{\mathrm{on}}}{r_{\mathrm{cut}} - r_{\mathrm{on}}}\Big\}\Big\}, \end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

with $r_{\rm on} = 2$, $r_{\rm cut} = 2.5$ (units of σ). The force includes the switch derivative $S'(r)u_0(r)$. Since $r_{\rm cut}\sigma < L/2$ for every system studied here, the minimum image is exact for the forces. All quantities are in reduced LJ units, $m = \sigma = \varepsilon = 1$.

Friction kernel (kernel A). The pair kernel is purely longitudinal,

$$K(\mathbf{r}) = g(r)\,\hat{\mathbf{r}}\hat{\mathbf{r}}^{\mathsf{T}} = c\,\frac{e^{-\kappa r}}{r^3}\,\mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^{\mathsf{T}}, \qquad g(r) = c\,\frac{e^{-\kappa r}}{r}, \qquad c = \gamma\, r_{\rm ref}\, e^{\kappa r_{\rm ref}}, \tag{3}$$

so that $g(r_{\rm ref}) = \gamma$. The project uses $\gamma = 0.5$, $\kappa = 0.7$, $r_{\rm ref} = 1.3$, hence $c = 1.6148$. There is no transverse projector. We write $K_\kappa(\mathbf{r}) = e^{-\kappa r}\mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^{\mathsf{T}}/r^3$ for the unit-amplitude kernel, so $K = cK_\kappa$. The screening κ is a physical parameter of the model; the Ewald parameter ξ introduced in Section 3 is numerical.

Full periodic convention. The friction between particles $i \neq j$ uses the lattice sum

$$K^{\rm per}(\mathbf{r}) = \sum_{\mathbf{n}\in\mathbb{Z}^3} K(\mathbf{r} + \mathbf{n}L), \tag{4}$$

which converges absolutely for $\mathbf{r} \notin L\mathbb{Z}^3$ because $|K(\mathbf{r})| \le c\,e^{-\kappa r}/r$. Its Fourier coefficients are $V^{-1}\hat{K}(\mathbf{k})$ on the reciprocal lattice $\mathbf{k} \in (2\pi/L)\mathbb{Z}^3$, with $\hat{K}(\mathbf{k}) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{r}} K(\mathbf{r})\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{r}$. In particular the $k = 0$ coefficient

$$\hat{K}(\mathbf{0}) = \frac{\hat{g}(0)}{3}\mathbf{I}, \qquad \hat{g}(0) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^3} g(r)\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{r} = \frac{4\pi c}{\kappa^2}, \tag{5}$$

is finite because $\kappa > 0$ and is *retained*: nothing is subtracted from the lattice sum. (This differs from the tin-foil convention of Coulomb Ewald sums, where the $k = 0$ term is dropped.)

2.2 Graph-Laplacian structure

Definition 2.1 (Friction matrix)**.** For a configuration with pairwise distinct positions, $\Gamma(\mathbf{q}) \in \mathbb{R}^{3N\times 3N}$ has 3×3 blocks

$$\Gamma_{ij} = -K^{\rm per}(\mathbf{q}_i - \mathbf{q}_j) \quad (i \neq j), \qquad \Gamma_{ii} = \sum_{j\neq i} K^{\rm per}(\mathbf{q}_i - \mathbf{q}_j). \tag{6}$$

Equivalently, $(\Gamma\mathbf{v})_i = \sum_{j\neq i} K^{\rm per}(\mathbf{q}_i - \mathbf{q}_j)(\mathbf{v}_i - \mathbf{v}_j)$.

Self images ($j = i$, $\mathbf{n} \neq \mathbf{0}$) would multiply $\mathbf{v}_i - \mathbf{v}_i = 0$ and therefore do not enter Γ. This cancellation is used again in the PPPM action (Section 3.4).

Proposition 2.2 (Structure of Γ)**.** *Let $T_\alpha = \mathbf{1}_N \otimes e_\alpha$ ($\alpha = 1, 2, 3$) and let $\Pi = \mathbf{I} - \frac{1}{N}\sum_\alpha T_\alpha T_\alpha^{\mathsf{T}}$ be the orthogonal projector onto zero total momentum. Then*

1. *Γ is symmetric;*
2. *$\mathbf{v}^{\mathsf{T}}\Gamma\mathbf{v} = \sum_{i<j}(\mathbf{v}_i - \mathbf{v}_j)^{\mathsf{T}} K^{\rm per}(\mathbf{q}_i - \mathbf{q}_j)(\mathbf{v}_i - \mathbf{v}_j) \ge 0$, so Γ is positive semidefinite;*
3. *$\Gamma T_\alpha = 0$, hence $\Gamma\Pi = \Pi\Gamma = \Gamma$;*
4. *the $k = 0$ term contributes $\frac{\hat{g}(0)}{3V}(N\mathbf{I}_N - \mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^{\mathsf{T}}) \otimes \mathbf{I}_3$ to Γ, which acts on $\mathrm{Ran}(\Pi)$ as the multiple $\rho\hat{g}(0)/3$ of the identity, $\rho = N/V$.*

Proof. (1) $K(\mathbf{r}) = K(-\mathbf{r}) = K(\mathbf{r})^{\mathsf{T}}$, so K^{per} has the same symmetries. (2) Expand $(\Gamma\mathbf{v})_i$ and symmetrise over the pair (i, j); each $K(\mathbf{r}+\mathbf{n}L) = g\,\hat{\mathbf{r}}\hat{\mathbf{r}}^{\mathsf{T}}$ with $g \geq 0$ is positive semidefinite, so K^{per} is positive semidefinite pointwise and every pair term is nonnegative. (3) The rows of each block row sum to zero by (6). (4) Insert the $k = 0$ Fourier coefficient $V^{-1}\hat{K}(\mathbf{0})$ into (6); on $\mathrm{Ran}(\Pi)$, $\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^{\mathsf{T}} \otimes \mathbf{I}_3$ vanishes. □

Positivity in item 2 follows from the *pointwise* positivity of the real-space kernel, not from its Fourier transform. In fact $\hat{K}_\kappa(\mathbf{k}) = a(k)(\mathbf{I} - \hat{\mathbf{k}}\hat{\mathbf{k}}^{\mathsf{T}}) + \lambda_\parallel(k)\hat{\mathbf{k}}\hat{\mathbf{k}}^{\mathsf{T}}$ with

$$a(k) = \frac{4\pi\,[k - \kappa \arctan(k/\kappa)]}{k^3}, \qquad \lambda_\parallel(k) = \frac{4\pi}{k^2 + \kappa^2} - 2a(k), \tag{7}$$

and $\lambda_\parallel(k) < 0$ for sufficiently large k (for $\kappa = 0.7$, $\lambda_\parallel(1.3) = -0.484$). The closed form (7) is derived in Appendix A.3 and was checked against direct radial quadrature to $\leq 7 \times 10^{-10}$ relative error. Consequently, a truncated or discretised Fourier representation of Γ need not be positive semidefinite, and positivity of the PPPM operator must be checked numerically (Section 5.2).

Remark 2.3 (Strict positivity on $\mathrm{Ran}(\Pi)$). Proposition 2.2 gives only $\Gamma \succeq 0$. Whether $\ker\Gamma$ equals $\mathrm{span}\{T_\alpha\}$ is not proved here. Numerically, the smallest eigenvalue of the PPPM matrix on $\mathrm{Ran}(\Pi)$ was between 4.58 and 4.84 on all 152 configurations of Section 5.2, and item 4 shows that the $k = 0$ term alone contributes $\rho\hat{g}(0)/3 = 10.35$ at $\rho = 0.75$. On an earlier test system, removing the $k = 0$ term made the matrix indefinite (Appendix D).

2.3 Momentum, invariant measure and what is not conserved

Proposition 2.4. *(i) Total momentum $P = \sum_i \mathbf{p}_i$ is conserved pathwise by (1). (ii) The Gibbs density $\pi(\mathbf{q}, \mathbf{p}) \propto \exp\{-[U(\mathbf{q}) + |\mathbf{p}|^2/(2m)]/k_{\mathrm{B}}T\}$, restricted to a fixed value of P, is stationary for (1).*

Proof. (i) $\sum_i F_i = 0$ for pair forces, $T_\alpha^{\mathsf{T}}\Gamma = 0$, and $T_\alpha^{\mathsf{T}}\Gamma^{1/2} = 0$ because $\Gamma^{1/2}$ has the same null space as Γ. (ii) The Hamiltonian part preserves π. For the friction part the Fokker–Planck operator is $\nabla_{\mathbf{p}} \cdot [\Gamma(\mathbf{q})(\frac{\mathbf{p}}{m}\pi + k_{\mathrm{B}}T\nabla_{\mathbf{p}}\pi)]$, which vanishes since $k_{\mathrm{B}}T\nabla_{\mathbf{p}}\pi = -\frac{\mathbf{p}}{m}\pi$. No spurious drift appears because Γ depends on $\mathbf{q}$ only and the noise acts on $\mathbf{p}$. □

Unlike the Landau particle system of Ref. [14], $\Gamma\mathbf{p} \neq 0$ in general, so kinetic energy is *not* conserved; the model is a thermostat. Item (ii) is a property of the continuous model. The time-discrete scheme preserves the Maxwell distribution exactly in its O-step (Section 4.2) but its stationary distribution in $\mathbf{q}$ carries a time-step bias, which is the subject of Section 5.3.

Continuous, discrete and numerical statements. Throughout we separate (a) properties of the continuous kernel and of Γ in (6), which are proved; (b) properties of the PPPM matrix Γ_h that hold by construction (symmetry, $\Gamma_h T_\alpha = 0$); and (c) properties that are only checked numerically (positivity of Γ_h on $\mathrm{Ran}\,\Pi$, operator error, Lanczos error).

3 Ewald splitting and matrix-free PPPM

3.1 Gaussian-scale representation by one integration by parts

For $\kappa > 0$ let

$$w_\kappa(s) = \frac{e^{-\kappa^2/(4s)}}{\sqrt{\pi s}}, \qquad \frac{e^{-\kappa r}}{r} = \int_0^\infty w_\kappa(s)\, e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s \quad (r > 0), \tag{8}$$

which is the standard Yukawa representation (it follows from $\int_0^\infty s^{-1/2}e^{-a/s-bs}\,\mathrm{d}s = \sqrt{\pi/b}\,e^{-2\sqrt{ab}}$ with $a=\kappa^2/4$, $b=r^2$). Define the weight ρ_κ by

$$\rho_\kappa'(s) = w_\kappa(s), \quad \rho_\kappa(0)=0, \qquad \rho_\kappa(s) = 2\sqrt{\frac{s}{\pi}}\,e^{-\kappa^2/(4s)} - \kappa\,\mathrm{erfc}\left(\frac{\kappa}{2\sqrt{s}}\right) > 0. \tag{9}$$

Here ρ_κ is an integration weight on the Gaussian scale s, not a number density. Differentiating the closed form reproduces w_κ (the two terms $\pm\frac{\kappa^2}{2\sqrt{\pi}}s^{-3/2}e^{-\kappa^2/4s}$ cancel), and $\rho_\kappa(s)\to 0$ as $s\to 0^+$.

Lemma 3.1. *For $r>0$, $\dfrac{e^{-\kappa r}}{r^3} = \displaystyle\int_0^\infty \rho_\kappa(s)\,e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s.$*

Proof. Integrate by parts with ρ_κ and $-e^{-sr^2}/r^2$:

$$\int_0^\infty \rho_\kappa e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s = \Big[-\rho_\kappa(s)\frac{e^{-sr^2}}{r^2}\Big]_0^\infty + \frac{1}{r^2}\int_0^\infty w_\kappa(s)e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s.$$

At $s=0$ the boundary term vanishes because $\rho_\kappa(0)=0$. As $s\to\infty$, $\rho_\kappa(s)\le 2\sqrt{s/\pi}$ while e^{-sr^2} decays exponentially, so the term vanishes. The remaining integral is $e^{-\kappa r}/r^3$ by (8). □

Hence, including the amplitude,

$$K(\mathbf{r}) = c\,\mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^{\mathsf{T}}\int_0^\infty \rho_\kappa(s)\,e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s. \tag{10}$$

The representation was checked numerically at $\kappa=0.7$ to round-off (relative error $\le 10^{-15}$ at $r\in\{0.3,1,2.5,5\}$).

3.2 Splitting at $s=\xi^2$

For $\xi>0$ define

$$K_L(\mathbf{r}) = c\,\mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^{\mathsf{T}}\int_0^{\xi^2}\rho_\kappa(s)e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s, \qquad K_S(\mathbf{r}) = c\,\mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^{\mathsf{T}}\int_{\xi^2}^\infty \rho_\kappa(s)e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s, \tag{11}$$

so $K=K_S+K_L$ exactly. Both are of the form $\theta(r)\hat{\mathbf{r}}\hat{\mathbf{r}}^{\mathsf{T}}$ with $\theta_{S,L}\ge 0$, because $\rho_\kappa>0$: each part is again pointwise positive semidefinite and longitudinal.

Short-range part. With $z=\kappa/(2\xi)$, substituting $\rho_\kappa=\int_0^s w_\kappa$ and exchanging the order of integration gives the closed form used in the code,

$$\theta_S(r) = c\Big\{\frac{1}{2r}\big[e^{\kappa r}\,\mathrm{erfc}(\xi r+z) + e^{-\kappa r}\,\mathrm{erfc}(\xi r - z)\big] + \rho_\kappa(\xi^2)\,e^{-\xi^2 r^2}\Big\}, \qquad \rho_\kappa(\xi^2) = \frac{2\xi}{\sqrt{\pi}}\,h(z), \tag{12}$$

with $h(z)=e^{-z^2}-\sqrt{\pi}z\,\mathrm{erfc}\,z$. We verified (12) against the s-integral at the production values $\kappa=0.7$, $\xi=0.85$ to $\le 8\times 10^{-16}$. Since $e^{-sr^2}\le e^{-\xi^2 r^2}$ for $s\ge\xi^2$, θ_S decays as $e^{-\xi^2r^2}$; to leading order $\theta_S(r)\sim c\,\rho_\kappa(\xi^2)e^{-\xi^2r^2}$.

Long-range part. K_L is smooth (C^∞): $K_L = \mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^\mathsf{T} g_L(r^2)$ with $g_L(u) = c\int_0^{\xi^2} \rho_\kappa e^{-su}\,\mathrm{d}s$ entire in u. Using $\int e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{r}} x_i x_j e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{r} = \pi^{3/2}\big[\tfrac{1}{2}\delta_{ij}s^{-5/2} - \tfrac{1}{4}k_i k_j s^{-7/2}\big]e^{-k^2/(4s)}$,

$$\hat{K}_L(\mathbf{k}) = A(k)\mathbf{I} + B(k)\mathbf{k}\mathbf{k}^\mathsf{T}, \qquad \begin{aligned} A(k) &= \frac{c\pi^{3/2}}{2}\int_0^{\xi^2} \rho_\kappa s^{-5/2} e^{-k^2/(4s)}\,\mathrm{d}s, \\ B(k) &= -\frac{c\pi^{3/2}}{4}\int_0^{\xi^2} \rho_\kappa s^{-7/2} e^{-k^2/(4s)}\,\mathrm{d}s. \end{aligned} \tag{13}$$

Both integrals converge at $s \to 0$ because $\rho_\kappa(s) = O(s^{3/2}e^{-\kappa^2/(4s)})$ there; in particular $A(0)$ is finite, which is what allows the $k = 0$ mode to be retained. Since $s \le \xi^2$ on the domain, $|A(k)|, |B(k)|k^2 \le Ce^{-k^2/(4\xi^2)}$; the leading asymptotics as $k \to \infty$ are $A \sim (4\pi c\, h(z)/k^2)e^{-k^2/4\xi^2}$ and $Bk^2 \sim -(2\pi c\, h(z)/\xi^2)e^{-k^2/4\xi^2}$, with $h(z)$ as in (12). They follow from Laplace's method at the endpoint $s = \xi^2$ (project derivation note, checked numerically at $\kappa = \xi = 1$, Appendix D; at $\kappa = 0.7$, $\xi = 0.85$ the ratios to the leading terms are 0.93, 0.98 for A and 1.08, 1.02 for Bk^2 at $k = 4, 8$, and within 1% of one at $k = 16$; `manuscript/scripts/verify_closed_forms.py`). The longitudinal eigenvalue $A + Bk^2$ of $\hat{K}_L$ is negative beyond some k_0, so $\hat{K}_L$ is not positive semidefinite even though $\theta_L \ge 0$ pointwise.

Remark 3.2 (Hessian form). An equivalent representation is $K_\kappa = \nabla\nabla\varphi_\kappa + \psi_\kappa\mathbf{I}$ with

$$\varphi_\kappa(r) = \int_0^\infty \frac{\rho_\kappa(s)}{4s^2}e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s, \qquad \psi_\kappa(r) = \int_0^\infty \frac{\rho_\kappa(s)}{2s}e^{-sr^2}\,\mathrm{d}s,$$

because $\nabla\nabla e^{-sr^2}/(4s^2) = \mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^\mathsf{T}e^{-sr^2} - \mathbf{I}e^{-sr^2}/(2s)$ for every s. Cutting both s-integrals at the same ξ^2 therefore cancels the identity terms scale by scale and returns exactly K_S and K_L of (11). This is an equivalent form, not a different algorithm. Closed forms ($x = \kappa r$, E_1 the exponential integral) are

$$\psi_\kappa(r) = \frac{e^{-x}}{r} - \kappa E_1(x), \qquad \varphi_\kappa(r) = \frac{1}{2\kappa}\big[(1-x)e^{-x} + x^2E_1(x)\big];$$

they follow from $\partial_{r^2}\psi_\kappa = -\tfrac{1}{2}e^{-\kappa r}/r^3$ and $\partial_{r^2}\varphi_\kappa = -\tfrac{1}{2}\psi_\kappa$ with zero limits at infinity (Appendix A.2), and were checked against the s-integrals to $\le 1.4 \times 10^{-15}$ and against a finite-difference Hessian to 1.3×10^{-8} (finite-difference limited).

3.3 Truncation and the balanced parameter

The real-space sum keeps pair images with $|\mathbf{r}_{ij} + \mathbf{n}L| \le r_c$; the Fourier sum keeps $|\mathbf{k}| \le k_c$. With the balanced choice

$$\xi r_c = \frac{k_c}{2\xi} = s_* \qquad \Longleftrightarrow \qquad r_c = \frac{s_*}{\xi}, \quad k_c = 2\xi s_*, \tag{14}$$

both truncation tails scale as $e^{-s_*^2}$ to leading order. (We write s_* for the dimensionless accuracy parameter, called s in the code, to avoid confusion with the Gaussian scale s.) On the $\kappa = 1$ test configurations the measured ratios were $\epsilon_S/e^{-s_*^2} = 0.34$–$0.79$ and $\epsilon_F/e^{-s_*^2} = 0.18$–$0.44$, and fits of $\log\epsilon = a - cx^2$ on 44 static $\kappa = 1$ configurations gave median rates $c = 0.99$ (real space) and 0.97 (Fourier) (Appendices D and D.2). These are checks on the unit kernel, not at the LJ+A state point.

Cost balance. At fixed s_* the number of real-space pair images per particle is about $\frac{4\pi}{3}\rho r_c^3 \propto \xi^{-3}$, whereas the number of mesh points needed to resolve k_c is $M^3 \approx (Lk_c/(\pi\eta))^3 \propto \xi^3 V$ for a mesh parameter $\eta = k_c h/\pi < 1$. The optimal ξ balances the two; at fixed density it does not grow

with N, so the cost per action is $O(N)$ for the real-space and spreading parts plus $O(M^3 \log M)$ for the FFTs. The value $\xi = 0.85$ used here was chosen by an explicit cost search at the earlier toy state point (Appendix D); at $N = 256$, $\rho = 0.75$ it gives $r_c = 4.82 > L/2 = 3.49$, so the real-space sum includes several images per pair. Its optimality at the present state point has not been re-established.

3.4 Particle–mesh action of Γ_L

Let W be the tensor-product cardinal B-spline of order p on a mesh of spacing $h = L/M$, with Fourier transform $\hat{W}(\mathbf{k}) = \prod_a \mathrm{sinc}^p(k_a h/2)$. For a vector $X = (\mathbf{x}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{x}_N)$, one PPPM action is:

1. spread $\mathbf{x}_j$ to the mesh with weights $W(\cdot - \mathbf{q}_j)$ (three components);
2. FFT, multiply by the 3×3 influence function $G_h(\mathbf{k}) = \hat{K}_L(\mathbf{k})/|\hat{W}(\mathbf{k})|^2$ for $|\mathbf{k}| \le k_c$ (zero otherwise; modes with $|\hat{W}|^2 \le 10^{-10}$ are excluded and reported—none at the production setting), inverse FFT;
3. gather with the same weights (the adjoint of step 1), giving $\mathbf{u}_i = \sum_j W^h_{ij} \mathbf{x}_j$.

The influence function is the plain deconvolved $\hat{K}_L/|\hat{W}|^2$, not an optimised influence function in the sense of Ref. [4]. The mesh pair matrix W^h_{ij} includes self terms W^h_{ii}. We form the graph-Laplacian action

$$(\Gamma^h_L X)_i = \tilde{D}_i \mathbf{x}_i - \mathbf{u}_i, \qquad \tilde{D}_i = \sum_j W^h_{ij} \text{ (self included)}, \tag{15}$$

where $\tilde{D}_i$ is obtained by applying steps 1–3 to the three translation fields. The self terms $W^h_{ii}\mathbf{x}_i - W^h_{ii}\mathbf{x}_i$ cancel identically, so no separate self-interaction correction is needed, and $\Gamma^h_L T_\alpha = 0$ holds by construction (to round-off). The $k = 0$ mode is included with coefficient $A(0)$. The full operator is $\Gamma_h = \Gamma^{r_c}_S + \Gamma^h_L$, with $\Gamma^{r_c}_S$ the graph Laplacian of K_S over all pair images within r_c (KD-tree search). Γ_h is symmetric because spreading and gathering are adjoint and G_h is real, symmetric and even in $\mathbf{k}$. The implementation is in `test_parameter_selection.py` (`Mesh`), `test_lanczos_fdt.py` (`GammaH`) and `radial_kernels.py` (`FastFriction`).

3.5 Error components and the norms used

We distinguish four spatial error sources and state the norm in which each is measured.

Truncation real-space cutoff r_c and Fourier cutoff k_c; analysed through (14).

Mesh aliasing and position-dependent transfer errors of the PPPM action, measured against the mesh-free Fourier sum over the same modes. On static $\kappa = 1$ configurations the deconvolution error was negligible, the linear cross terms between principal term and aliases carried 0.996–1.003 of the mesh error, and the fitted slopes for $\eta \approx 0.23$–0.50 were consistent with an h^p trend (Appendix D.2; an earlier study gave 0.92–1.03, Appendix D).

Operator the total $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}} = \|\Gamma_h - \Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2 / \|\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2$ (spectral norm), where Γ_{ref} is the dense full-periodic lattice-sum matrix (6) with the $k = 0$ term retained (near images summed directly, far images by a tensor Chebyshev fit, brute-force self-check 9.4×10^{-16} of the largest entry). Because the $k = 0$ term is exact in both matrices and contributes 10.35 of $\lambda_{\max} \approx 12$, $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}}$ is also reported relative to $\|\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}} - \frac{\hat{g}(0)}{3V}(N\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^{\mathsf{T}}) \otimes \mathbf{I}_3\|_2$ ("$k \neq 0$ part"). The budget $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}} \le 2 \times 10^{-7}$ applies to the full-norm definition.

Lanczos the relative 2-norm error $\|f_r(\Gamma_h)\mathbf{v} - f(\Gamma_h)\mathbf{v}\|_2/\|\mathbf{v}\|_2$ of the rank-r approximation against the dense matrix function of the *same* Γ_h, separately for damping and noise functions (Section 4.3).

"Dense reference" therefore has two meanings that we keep apart: the full-periodic matrix Γ_{ref} (the model) and the dense assembly of the PPPM matrix Γ_h (the approximation, used to isolate the Lanczos error).

4 Time integration and correlated noise

4.1 BAOAB splitting

One step of size h (written $\mathrm{d}t$ in the numerical sections) is

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{B: } \mathbf{p} \leftarrow \mathbf{p} + \tfrac{h}{2}F(\mathbf{q}), \qquad \text{A: } \mathbf{q}_{1/2} = \mathbf{q} + \tfrac{h}{2m}\mathbf{p}, \\ &\text{O: } \mathbf{p} \leftarrow \bar{\mathbf{p}} + R_h\Pi\mathbf{p} + S_h\Pi\boldsymbol{\zeta}, \quad \boldsymbol{\zeta} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I}_{3N}), \\ &\text{A: } \mathbf{q} \leftarrow \mathbf{q}_{1/2} + \tfrac{h}{2m}\mathbf{p}, \qquad \text{B: } \mathbf{p} \leftarrow \mathbf{p} + \tfrac{h}{2}F(\mathbf{q}), \end{aligned} \tag{16}$$

where $\bar{\mathbf{p}} = (\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^{\mathsf{T}}/N \otimes \mathbf{I}_3)\mathbf{p}$ is the centre-of-mass part and, with $\Gamma = \Gamma_h(\mathbf{q}_{1/2})$ evaluated *once* per step,

$$R_h = e^{-h\Gamma/m}, \qquad S_h = \left[k_{\mathrm{B}}T\, m\, (\mathbf{I} - e^{-2h\Gamma/m})\right]^{1/2} \tag{17}$$

on $\mathrm{Ran}(\Pi)$. The same Γ is used for damping and noise. This is the splitting of Ref. [15] with a configuration-dependent matrix friction; we do not claim its known convergence properties for constant friction transfer to the present case.

4.2 The O-step is the exact OU map for frozen friction

Proposition 4.1 (Finite-time FDT)**.** *For frozen $\Gamma \succeq 0$ with $\Gamma T_\alpha = 0$, the O-step of (16) with exact R_h, S_h has the law of the solution at time h of $\mathrm{d}\mathbf{p} = -\Gamma\mathbf{p}/m\,\mathrm{d}t + \sqrt{2k_{\mathrm{B}}T}\Gamma^{1/2}\,\mathrm{d}W$. It (i) copies total momentum exactly, and (ii) leaves $\mathcal{N}(\bar{\mathbf{p}},\, mk_{\mathrm{B}}T\,\Pi)$ invariant.*

Proof. The OU solution is $e^{-h\Gamma/m}\mathbf{p}$ plus a centred Gaussian with covariance

$$\int_0^h e^{-u\Gamma/m}\, 2k_{\mathrm{B}}T\Gamma\, e^{-u\Gamma/m}\,\mathrm{d}u = k_{\mathrm{B}}Tm(\mathbf{I} - e^{-2h\Gamma/m})\Pi = S_h^2,$$

since Γ commutes with Π. (i) $T_\alpha^{\mathsf{T}}\Pi = 0$, so $\bar{\mathbf{p}}$ is copied. (ii) If $\Pi\mathbf{p} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, mk_{\mathrm{B}}T\Pi)$ then $R_h(mk_{\mathrm{B}}T\Pi)R_h + S_h^2 = mk_{\mathrm{B}}T\Pi$. □

Thus the O-step introduces no time-step error for frozen positions; the time-step bias of the scheme comes from the B/A splitting and from freezing Γ at $\mathbf{q}_{1/2}$. Kinetic energy is not conserved by the O-step, consistent with Proposition 2.4. Momentum is carried exactly in the implementation (the centre-of-mass part is copied and both matrix-function outputs are projected by Π).

4.3 Fixed-rank Lanczos on $\mathrm{Ran}(\Pi)$

$R_h\Pi\mathbf{p}$ and $S_h\Pi\boldsymbol{\zeta}$ are evaluated by Algorithm 1 with $f(\lambda) = e^{-h\lambda/m}$ (damping) and $f(\lambda) = [k_{\mathrm{B}}Tm(1 - e^{-2h\lambda/m})]^{1/2}$ (noise), using only Γ_h actions.

Ranks are fixed per configuration file, not adaptive. For the LJ+A production set the verified ranks are 14 (noise) and 5 (damping); the trajectories analysed in Sections 5.3 and 5.4 used 12/5

Algorithm 1 Direct-start Lanczos approximation of $f(\Gamma_h)\mathbf{v}$ on $\mathrm{Ran}(\Pi)$ (`test_lanczos_fdt.lanczos`, `test_true_dynamics.lanczos_apply`)

Require: $\mathbf{v} \in \mathrm{Ran}(\Pi)$, rank r, action $X \mapsto \Gamma_h X$

$\mathbf{w}_1 = \mathbf{v}/\|\mathbf{v}\|$
for $k = 1, \dots, r$ **do**
  $\mathbf{y} = \Pi\,\Gamma_h \mathbf{w}_k$; $\alpha_k = \mathbf{w}_k^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{y}$; $\mathbf{y} \leftarrow \mathbf{y} - \alpha_k \mathbf{w}_k - \beta_{k-1}\mathbf{w}_{k-1}$
  full re-orthogonalisation against $\mathbf{w}_1, \dots, \mathbf{w}_k$ (two passes); $\mathbf{y} \leftarrow \Pi\mathbf{y}$
  $\beta_k = \|\mathbf{y}\|$; stop early if $\beta_k \le 10^{-13} \max|\alpha|$; $\mathbf{w}_{k+1} = \mathbf{y}/\beta_k$
end for
$T_r = \mathrm{tridiag}(\beta, \alpha, \beta) = U\Theta U^{\mathsf{T}}$
if $\min\Theta \le 0$ **then abort** (no clipping of Ritz values)
end if
return $\Pi(\|\mathbf{v}\|\,[\mathbf{w}_1, \dots, \mathbf{w}_r]\,U f(\Theta) U^{\mathsf{T}} e_1)$

(see Section 5.2 for why the recommendation was raised). A Landau-style range start ($\mathbf{w}_1 \propto \Pi\Gamma_h\boldsymbol{\zeta}$ with $f(\lambda)/\lambda$) was tested on earlier configurations and needed 1.13–1.43 times more rank; direct start is used (Appendix D).

Finite-time noise covariance with Lanczos. With exact S_h, $\mathrm{Cov}(S_h\Pi\boldsymbol{\zeta}) = S_h^2$ exactly. The Lanczos output $\boldsymbol{\eta}_r = f_r(\Gamma_h; \Pi\boldsymbol{\zeta})$ depends nonlinearly on its starting vector, so it is not exactly Gaussian. Writing $\mathbf{e} = \boldsymbol{\eta}_r - S_h\Pi\boldsymbol{\zeta}$, $\|\mathrm{Cov}(\boldsymbol{\eta}_r) - S_h^2\|_2 \le 2\,\mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{e}\|\|S_h\Pi\boldsymbol{\zeta}\|] + \mathbb{E}\|\mathbf{e}\|^2$, so the covariance error is controlled by the per-sample error that we measure on probe vectors and on the actual noise draws (Section 5.2). We do not have an a priori bound on $\|\mathbf{e}\|$ for the present spectra; the ranks are verified empirically. In the same spirit, the stationary distribution of the discrete scheme with Lanczos noise is not characterised analytically.

4.4 Exact nested noise coupling across time steps

To compare time steps pathwise, levels h and $2h$ are driven by coupled noise. The finest level draws $\boldsymbol{\zeta} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \Pi)$. A coarse step builds its input from two successive fine inputs $\boldsymbol{\zeta}_1, \boldsymbol{\zeta}_2$ using its *own* friction matrix $\Gamma_c = \Gamma_h(\mathbf{q}^c_{1/2})$:

$$\boldsymbol{\zeta}_c = a(\Gamma_c)\boldsymbol{\zeta}_1 + b(\Gamma_c)\boldsymbol{\zeta}_2, \qquad a = \frac{e^{-x}}{\sqrt{1+e^{-2x}}}, \quad b = \frac{1}{\sqrt{1+e^{-2x}}}, \quad x = \frac{h\Gamma_c}{m}. \tag{18}$$

Since $a^2 + b^2 = \mathbf{I}$ and a, b commute with Π, $\boldsymbol{\zeta}_c \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \Pi)$ conditionally on the past, so every level samples its own correct law. For frozen Γ, one coarse O-step equals two fine ones, because $S_{2h}^{-1} S_h = (1 + e^{-2x})^{-1/2}$. In the implementation this identity holds to 3×10^{-15} (dense) and $\le 4 \times 10^{-11}$ (Lanczos). Seed equality alone would not couple the levels.

5 Numerical experiments

The experiments are organised in four layers: spatial operator (Section 5.2), time discretisation (Section 5.3), physical observables (Section 5.4) and cost (Section 5.5). Static configurations are used where time integration is irrelevant, so spatial and temporal errors are not mixed. All arithmetic is IEEE double precision; stored trajectories are float32. All numbers are taken from the result

Table 1: Runs used in this paper (LJ+A, $N = 256$, $\rho^* = 0.75$, $k_\mathrm{B}T = 1$, $m = 1$, PPPM $\xi = 0.85$, $s_* = 4.1$, $p = 8$, $M = 24$ in every row, except the comparators named in the row: the tight PPPM set of the sensitivity test and the dense Γ_ref of the pilot). "Canonical start": random sequential addition (RSA, $d_\mathrm{min} = 0.9$) or jittered fcc, followed by scalar Langevin BAOAB ($\gamma = 1$, conservative forces only, $\mathrm{d}t = 0.005$) for 30–50 time units. Ranks are noise/damping (coupling).

experiment	dt	ranks	initial states / replicas	length / burn-in	saved
static verification (repr.)	– (0.00125–0.01 for f)	scan 2–56	42 states: 18 fcc/RSA canonical, 23 starts of dynamic runs, 1 jittered fcc	static	–
static verification (visited)	as above	scan 2–56	72 equilibration frames (exact O-step inputs) + 38 dt/long-D frames	static	–
equilibration	0.005	12/5	8 runs, seeds 301–308: fcc, RSA, canonical, canonical with $k_\mathrm{B}T = 2$ momenta (2 each)	50; burn-in estimated 2, recommended 5	every step
dt study	0.00125, 0.0025, 0.005, 0.01 (coupled)	12/5 (4)	16 canonical starts (replicas 101–112, 116–119)	$t_\mathrm{end} = 10$; analysis window $[1, 10]$	every step
long-D chains	0.005, 0.01 (coupled)	12/5 (4)	11 canonical starts (113–115, 121–128)	100; analysed after $T_0 = 10$	every 0.01
operator sensitivity	0.005	12/5	2 replicas, production vs tight PPPM ($s_* = 4.4$, $\eta = 0.6$, $p = 7$), same noise	10	–
step cost	0.005	12/5, 14/5	6 interleaved rounds × 40 steps, 1 thread	–	–
local pilot (Appendix C)	0.005, 0.01	14/5 vs dense Γ_ref	1 state (equilibration run s305, $t = 50$), paired noise per dt	$t = 1$, no burn-in	every step

files listed in the evidence map (`manuscript/evidence_map.md`). Error bars are 95% Student-t intervals over independent replicas unless stated otherwise. An interval that contains zero is never read as equivalence.

5.1 System, parameters and runs

The state point is fixed: LJ, $\rho^* = 0.75$, $k_\mathrm{B}T = 1.0$, $N = 256$, $L = (256/0.75)^{1/3} = 6.98864$, $m = 1$, $r_\mathrm{on} = 2$, $r_\mathrm{cut} = 2.5$; kernel A with $\gamma = 0.5$, $\kappa = 0.7$, $r_\mathrm{ref} = 1.3$ ($c = 1.6148$), full periodic, $k = 0$ retained. The PPPM set is $\xi = 0.85$, $s_* = 4.1$ ($r_c = 4.824$, $k_c = 6.97$), requested $\eta = 0.6779$, B-spline order $p = 8$, $M = 24$ (realised $\eta = 0.6460$), 1935 retained modes, none excluded. The initial PPPM set of the earlier state point used $p = 7$; it gave $\varepsilon_\mathrm{op} = 2.04$–$2.15 \times 10^{-7} > 2 \times 10^{-7}$ on fcc-lattice states at $\rho = 0.75$, so p was raised to 8. Table 1 lists the runs.

Table 2: Static verification of the PPPM operator and Lanczos ranks (law A). Source: `summary_tables.md`, generated from the listed JSON files.

state set	states	PPPM (η, p, M)	$\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}}$ (full)	$\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}}$ vs $k \neq 0$	strict ranks n/d/c
representative	42	0.6779, 8, 24	$6.1\text{–}7.3 \times 10^{-8}$	1.53×10^{-7}	12/5/4
visited, equilibration	72	0.6779, 8, 24	$6.1\text{–}7.6 \times 10^{-8}$	1.60×10^{-7}	14/5/5
visited, dt/long-D	38	0.6779, 8, 24	$6.7\text{–}7.4 \times 10^{-8}$	1.59×10^{-7}	12/5/4
representative, alt. 1	42	0.6, 7, 27	$6.1\text{–}7.6 \times 10^{-8}$	1.59×10^{-7}	12/5/4
representative, alt. 2 ($s_* = 4.4$)	42	0.6, 7, 30	$1.4\text{–}1.6 \times 10^{-8}$	3.3×10^{-8}	12/5/4

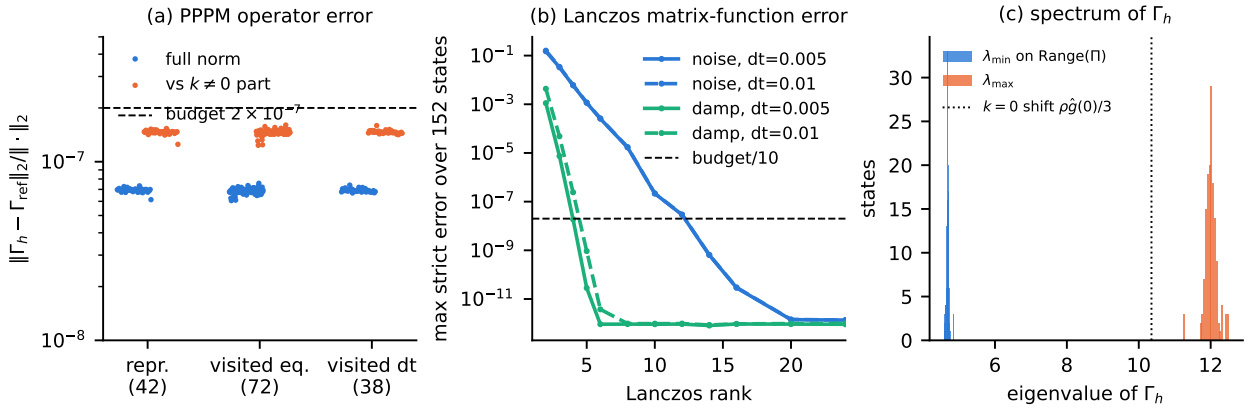


Figure 1: Static verification, LJ+A, $N = 256$, $\rho^* = 0.75$, $k_{\mathrm{B}}T = 1$, PPPM $\xi = 0.85$, $s_* = 4.1$, $p = 8$, $M = 24$; 152 configurations (42 representative, 72 equilibration-visited, 38 dt/long-D-visited); no error bars (each point is one configuration). (a) Spectral operator error $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}}$ against the full-periodic lattice-sum matrix, full norm and relative to the $k \neq 0$ part; dashed: budget. (b) Lanczos "strict" error, i.e. the maximum over probe types (overall, $|k| = 2\pi/L$ projection, lowest 3 and lowest 12 eigenmodes) and over all 152 states, relative to the exact output $f(\Gamma_h)\mathbf{v}$ (or to its $k_{\min}$ or low-mode projection for the component errors), against the dense matrix function of the same Γ_h; dashed: budget/10. (c) Extreme eigenvalues of Γ_h on Ran(Π); dotted: $k = 0$ contribution $\rho\hat{g}(0)/3 = 10.35$. Data: `lj075_results/verify_{representative,visited_eq,visited_dt}_A.json`; script `manuscript/scripts/make_figures.py`.

5.2 Spatial accuracy of the operator

Operator error. Figure 1(a) and Table 2 show $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}}$ for 42 representative states, 72 states visited by the equilibration runs (including frames at $t = 0, 0.25, 1, 5, 20, 50$, the frame of minimal pair distance and the frames of extreme Ritz values) and 38 frames of the dt chains and of long-D chains 113–115 (the long-D chains 121–128 were not checked on visited states). Over all 152 states $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}} \leq 7.6 \times 10^{-8}$, below the budget 2×10^{-7}; relative to the $k \neq 0$ part the maximum is 1.60×10^{-7}. The error on Gaussian probe vectors ($\leq 9.4 \times 10^{-8}$) and on the lowest 12 eigenvalues ($\leq 8.9 \times 10^{-8}$) is of the same size. Structural checks on all states: symmetry residual $\leq 2 \times 10^{-17}$, momentum null-space residual $\leq 2.4 \times 10^{-15}$ for both Γ_h and Γ_{ref}, literal FFT action versus independent dense assembly of $\Gamma_h \leq 8 \times 10^{-16}$, and $\lambda_{\min}(\Gamma_h|_{\mathrm{Ran}\,\Pi}) \geq 4.58$ (Figure 1(c)). Two alternative PPPM sets also pass the 42-state test (Table 2). The reference here is the model matrix Γ_{ref}, not a dense assembly of Γ_h. A component-by-component analysis of the same error (truncation, mesh, complete action) exists only for the unit kernel with $\kappa = 1$ on static synthetic configurations (Appendix D.2); it was not repeated at the LJ+A parameters.

Lanczos error. The Lanczos error is measured against the dense matrix function of the same Γ_h on 4 Gaussian and 4 Maxwell vectors, the actual momentum of the step, the actual noise draw (regenerated from the run's RNG stream for visited equilibration states), longitudinal and transverse plane waves at $|\mathbf{k}| = 2\pi/L$ and $\sqrt{2}\,2\pi/L$, and two slow-mode-dominated vectors. The strict rule requires the maximum of the overall error and of the $k_{\min}$, lowest-3 and lowest-12 components to be $\leq$ budget$/10 = 2 \times 10^{-8}$. On the representative states rank 12 suffices for the noise; on one visited state (a melting fcc start at $t = 5$) rank 12 gives a $k_{\min}$ component of 2.88×10^{-8}, driven by the transverse (1,1,0) plane wave. The noise rank was therefore raised to 14 (Figure 1(b)). At ranks 14/5 the worst Lanczos error over all 152 states at $\mathrm{d}t = 0.005$ is 6.4×10^{-10} (noise) and 2.8×10^{-11} (damping). The dt-study runs used 12/5; their on-line monitor on actual inputs (every 200–500 steps; `dt_study.json`) never exceeded 1.6×10^{-10} for the noise, 1.6×10^{-11} for damping and 3.5×10^{-10} for the coupling maps (overall norm); a $k_{\min}$-component maximum of 1.8×10^{-9} for the noise is stated in `REPORT.md` but is not stored in any result file. Monitor values for the equilibration and long-D runs are only in the raw (unavailable) output. Replacing Γ_h by Γ_{ref} in the O-step changes its output by at most 1.02×10^{-8}; the finite-time FDT residual (damping and noise from the same Γ_h) is $\leq 5.5 \times 10^{-11}$.

Physical effect of the operator error. Two replicas were run in lock-step with the same noise from the same start, once with the production set and once with a tighter set ($\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}} \leq 1.6 \times 10^{-8}$), at $\mathrm{d}t = 0.005$ for 10 time units. The largest differences of time averages were 5.9×10^{-5} (T_{kin}, relative), 1.4×10^{-5} (U/N), 1.3×10^{-4} (MSD at $t = 0.5$–5) and 4.5×10^{-4} (pressure, absolute). The RMS position difference grew from 10^{-9} at $t = 0.1$ to 1.0–1.6×10^{-2} at $t = 10$. With $n = 2$ these are observed maxima, not confidence intervals; the growth of the pathwise difference is not by itself evidence of a bias.

5.3 Time discretisation

We separate two questions: (i) at a fixed time step, how far is the fast method (PPPM+Lanczos) from a dense reference; (ii) for the fast method, how do results depend on $\mathrm{d}t$.

(i) Fast versus dense at the same dt. For LJ+A the only same-dt fast/dense trajectory comparison is the local pilot of Appendix C: one canonical state, one noise path per dt shared by both methods, $t \leq 1$, dense meaning Γ_{ref} with dense eigendecomposition. The RMS velocity difference at $t = 1$ was 7.4×10^{-8} ($\mathrm{d}t = 0.005$) and 7.8×10^{-8} ($\mathrm{d}t = 0.01$) of the RMS velocity, consistent with the size of the operator error and at least two orders of magnitude above the Lanczos error. This is a single path pair and supports no statement on statistical equivalence. A statistical fast/dense comparison with 16 paths per state exists only for the earlier $N = 64$ double-well system (Appendix D).

(ii) Time-step dependence: design. Four levels $\mathrm{d}t \in \{0.01, 0.005, 0.0025, 0.00125\}$ were integrated in lock-step from the same state to $t_{\mathrm{end}} = 10$ with the coupling (18), for 16 independent canonical starts (Table 1). Analysis is paired by replica; time averages use $[1, 10]$; the VACF uses every native step $t \geq 1$ as an origin, with lags on the common 0.01 grid; the MSD uses all origins with centre-of-mass motion removed. The acceptance criteria were committed (commit `91e20d4`) before the dt-study results were committed (`df43e2d`); that no run preceded the criteria is recorded only in the commit message: 1% relative for T_{kin}, U/N, the RDF first-peak height and position and MSD at $t = 0.1, 0.5, 1, 2, 5$; 0.0075 absolute for pressure; $E_g \leq 1\%$ for the RDF ($w = 4\pi\rho r^2\,\mathrm{d}r$ on $[0.5, L/2)$); $\max_{t \leq 2} |\Delta C|/C_{\mathrm{ref}}(0) \leq 1\%$ for the VACF. PASS means the entire 95% interval lies inside

Table 3: Pre-registered dt comparison against dt = 0.00125 (16 coupled replicas; mean [95% paired Student-t CI]; relative unless stated). RDF E_g rows give one-sided 95% upper bounds; the VACF row gives the maximum over $t \leq 2$ of pointwise lower and upper bounds, not a simultaneous band. P/I/F = PASS/INCONCLUSIVE/FAIL. Source: `lj075_results/dt_study.json`, `summary_tables.md`.

criterion	0.0025	0.005	0.01
T_{kin}	-0.11% $[-0.32, +0.09]$ P	-0.12% $[-0.30, +0.07]$ P	-0.52% $[-0.78, -0.26]$ P
U/N	-0.12% $[-0.23, -0.01]$ P	-0.05% $[-0.14, +0.04]$ P	-0.16% $[-0.29, -0.03]$ P
pressure (abs.)	-0.026 $[-0.049, -0.003]$ I	$+0.0006$ $[-0.018, +0.019]$ I	-0.024 $[-0.050, +0.002]$ I
RDF E_g, registered bootstrap bound	1.78% I	1.68% I	1.82% I
RDF E_g, debiased jackknife bound	1.02% I	0.98% P	1.02% I
RDF first-peak height	$+0.01\%$ $[-0.44, +0.47]$ P	-0.05% $[-0.50, +0.41]$ P	$+0.02\%$ $[-0.60, +0.64]$ P
RDF first-peak position	$+0.03\%$ $[-0.22, +0.28]$ P	0.00% $[-0.23, +0.22]$ P	-0.04% $[-0.23, +0.16]$ P
VACF E_V [lower, upper]	$[0, 0.39\%]$ P	$[0.004\%, 0.41\%]$ P	$[0.26\%, 0.78\%]$ P
MSD(0.1)	-0.03% $[-0.28, +0.22]$ P	$+0.04\%$ $[-0.19, +0.27]$ P	$+0.14\%$ $[-0.20, +0.48]$ P
MSD(0.5)	$+0.13\%$ $[-0.23, +0.50]$ P	$+0.41\%$ $[-0.36, +1.18]$ I	$+0.47\%$ $[-0.45, +1.40]$ I
MSD(1)	$+0.25\%$ $[-0.40, +0.90]$ P	$+0.52\%$ $[-0.63, +1.67]$ I	$+0.87\%$ $[-0.54, +2.28]$ I
MSD(2)	$+0.69\%$ $[-0.59, +1.98]$ I	$+0.89\%$ $[-1.08, +2.85]$ I	$+1.80\%$ $[-0.15, +3.75]$ I
MSD(5)	$+3.44\%$ $[+1.03, +5.86]$ **F**	$+3.08\%$ $[-0.20, +6.36]$ I	$+2.99\%$ $[-0.32, +6.31]$ I

the band, FAIL that it lies entirely outside, otherwise INCONCLUSIVE. The rule was: compare the finest two levels first, then accept the largest dt whose criteria all PASS. One amendment was made before any multi-replica analysis (Student-t instead of bootstrap bounds for function-valued criteria). Only after the results were in (commit `80f8191`) was it found that for the RDF norm the amended (debiased jackknife) bound is less strict; the registered bootstrap verdict is therefore the one used in the decision, although `dt_study.json` stores the amended verdict (PASS at 0.005). A Bonferroni family-wise view over 36 tests was added after an interim look and is secondary.

(ii) Results and decision. Table 3 and Figure 2 give the results. Under the registered rule *no time step is validated* at $n = 16$: the finest-two comparison is not all-PASS (pressure, RDF norm and MSD(2) are INCONCLUSIVE, MSD(5) FAILs), and no coarser level passes every criterion. On the subset of criteria that are decidable at this sample size (T, U/N, RDF first peak, VACF for $t \leq 2$, MSD(0.1)), all three coarse levels PASS; a rule restricted to that subset would pick dt = 0.01, but that rule is post hoc and is not used as validation.

dt = 0.005 versus 0.01. At dt = 0.01 the biases in T_{kin} (-0.52%) and U/N (-0.16%) are resolved (intervals exclude zero) though within 1%, and the VACF point statistic $E_V = 0.52\%$ exceeds its sign-flip noise floor (0.24%); its pointwise lower bound is 0.26%. At dt = 0.005 no interval of T_{kin} or U/N excludes zero, and only the pointwise VACF lower bound (0.004%) is nonzero. The MSD point estimates at $t = 0.5$–2 are larger at 0.01 than at 0.005 but unresolved. We therefore keep dt = 0.005 as a *provisional*, precautionary choice and regard dt = 0.01 as acceptable for static averages (T, U/N, RDF first peak) with the quoted biases. The configuration file records `dt_validated = None`, `dt_provisional = 0.005`.

The MSD(5) FAIL. The registered verdict for dt = 0.0025 is FAIL. A post-hoc diagnostic shows the same $\approx +3\%$ point estimate for every coarse level against 0.00125 (resolved only at 0.0025), while the differences among the coarse levels are small but not resolved (0.005 vs 0.0025: -0.35% $[-3.6, +2.9]$; 0.01 vs 0.005: -0.09% $[-3.6, +3.4]$); these intervals cannot exclude a 3% difference. The pattern would be compatible with a fluctuation of the reference level, but this reading is post hoc, is not established, and does not change the registered verdict.

Why the intervals are wide. The median RMS velocity difference against the 0.00125 path is

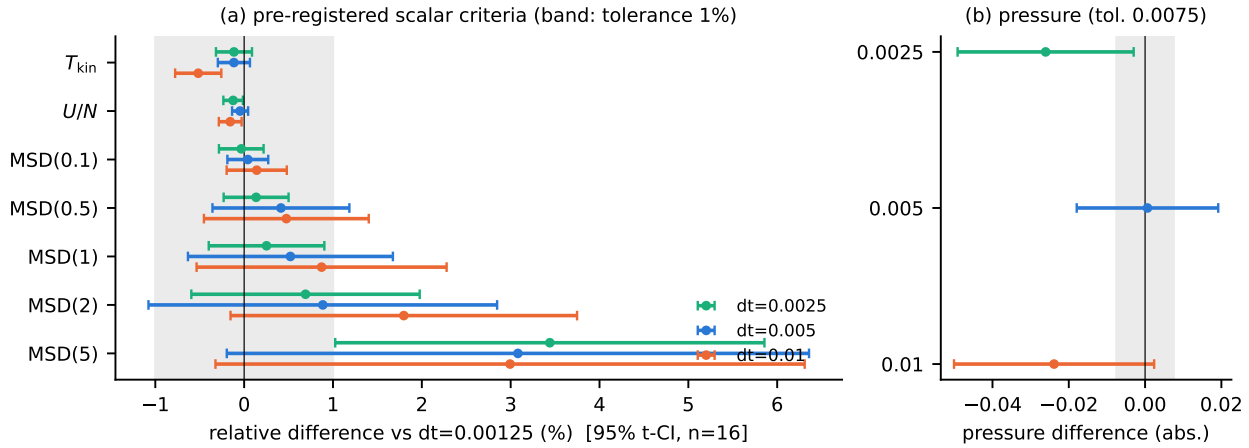


Figure 2: Pre-registered scalar dt criteria, LJ+A, $N = 256$; each level against dt = 0.00125, 16 coupled replicas (ranks 12/5, coupling 4), paired 95% Student-t intervals. Grey bands: registered tolerances. Shown: T_{kin}, U/N, pressure, MSD at five times; the VACF and RDF criteria (including the scalar RDF first-peak height and position) are listed in Table 3 only. Data: `lj075_results/dt_study.json`; script `manuscript/scripts/make_figures.py`.

0.025/0.057/0.12 at $t = 1$ and 0.10/0.20/0.40 at $t = 2$ (for 0.0025/0.005/0.01), reaching 0.80–0.86 at $t = 5$ (Figure 6 in Appendix B). At $t = 5$ this is about 60% of the value $\sqrt{2k_{\mathrm{B}}T/m} \approx 1.41$ for fully independent velocities, so pairing loses much of its variance reduction after $t \approx 1$–2; a paired-versus-unpaired variance comparison was not made. We do not attribute this decorrelation to a specific mechanism. Reaching a 1% verdict would need roughly 25 replicas for MSD(0.5) and 80 for MSD(1), and resolving the pressure tolerance roughly 60–100.

Long-time diffusion. Eleven coupled two-level chains (dt = 0.005 and 0.01, 100 time units, frames every 0.01) give windowed MSD diffusion coefficients (Figure 3). With a plateau rule fixed before the long runs were analysed (paired relative change between consecutive windows within ±2% over the whole 95% CI, required for every step up to the longest window), no plateau is confirmed at either dt. At dt = 0.005, D_{MSD} decreases by 1.9% $[1.2, 2.7]$ and then 1.1% $[0.2, 2.0]$ per window doubling up to $[4, 8]$, and later steps have intervals of ±1.4–2.6%. At dt = 0.01 the decreases are 2.0% $[1.3, 2.8]$ and 1.6% $[0.8, 2.3]$, one later step meets the plateau condition (+0.16% $[-1.11, +1.42]$) and the last does not (-0.96% $[-3.41, +1.50]$). The best current estimate is $D \approx 0.0283$–0.0286 (dt = 0.005, windows $[4, 8]$–$[16, 32]$, 95% half-widths 1.4–2.4%), not a converged long-time value. The paired dt effect $D(0.01)/D(0.005) - 1$ is resolved only in the shortest window (+0.80% $[+0.05, +1.55]$).

5.4 Physical observables

Static and thermodynamic quantities. Eight equilibration runs from four start types (Table 1) give pool means (for $t \geq 25$) $U/N = -4.6697$, $T_{\mathrm{kin}} = 1.0003$, pressure 0.770 and RDF first-peak height 2.558 (Figure 7 in Appendix B). The kinetic temperature is $T_{\mathrm{kin}} = \sum_i |\mathbf{p}_i - \bar{\mathbf{p}}|^2/(3m(N-1))$; the pressure is $P = (2K' + W)/(3V)$ with K' the centre-of-mass-free kinetic energy and $W = -\sum_{i<j} r_{ij} u'(r_{ij})$ the conservative virial (friction and noise do not enter). A burn-in of 2 time units was measured by a block rule fixed before the analysis (last 2-unit block deviating by more than $4 s_B/\sqrt{n_g}$ from the pool); 5 units are recommended. Start-type dependence after

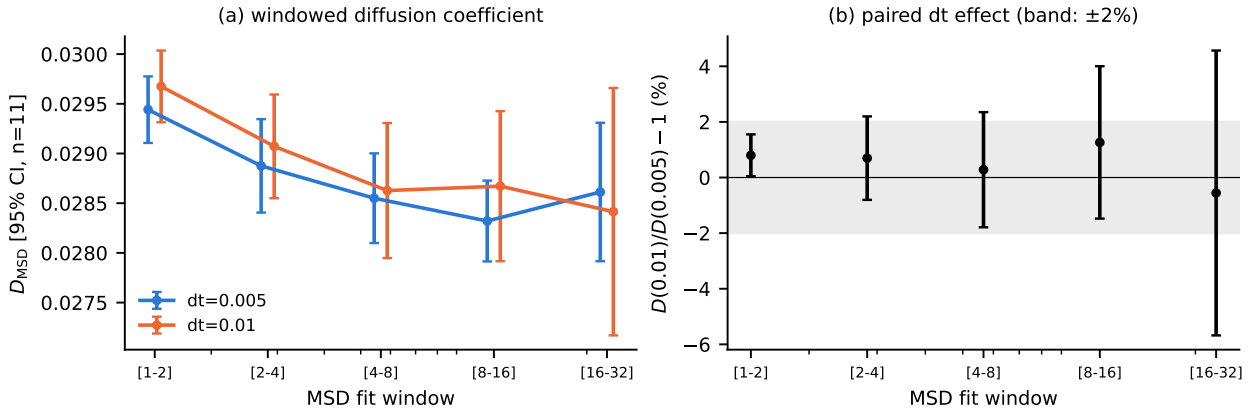


Figure 3: Windowed diffusion coefficient, LJ+A, $N = 256$; 11 coupled two-level chains of 100 time units, frames every 0.01, analysis after $T_0 = 10$, ranks 12/5. (a) D_{MSD} from linear fits of the MSD on the indicated windows; 95% Student-t intervals over chains. (b) Paired relative difference between the two time steps, 95% CI; grey band: ±2% for orientation only (there is no registered dt tolerance for D; the ±2% plateau rule concerns window-to-window changes). Data: `lj075_results/longD.json`; script `manuscript/scripts/make_figures.py`.

burn-in was not detected (one-way ANOVA $p = 0.21$–0.78), but with 2 runs per start type this test has low power, so initial-state independence is under-sampled, not verified. From the between-run spread, the replicas of 48 time units needed for a 95% half-width are 7 (T_{kin} to ±0.2%), 4 (U/N to ±0.2%), 4 (RDF peak to ±0.5%), 10 ($D_{\mathrm{GK}}(16)$ to ±5%) and 25 (pressure to ±0.0075). The save interval must be one step at dt = 0.005 for VACF/Green–Kubo (quadrature bias 0.23% at $\Delta = 0.01$ against a 0.2% rule), whereas the MSD is unaffected up to $\Delta = 0.1$ (within ±0.1%).

Dynamical correlation functions: definitions. These follow the project definitions (reproduced to $\leq 10^{-15}$ on a real trajectory):

$$Z(t) = \frac{\langle \mathbf{v}_i(t_0) \cdot \mathbf{v}_i(t_0+t)\rangle}{\langle |\mathbf{v}|^2\rangle}, \qquad C_b(t) = \frac{\langle \mathbf{v}_i(t_0) \cdot \mathbf{v}_j(t_0+t)\rangle_{r_{ij}(t_0)\in b}}{\langle |\mathbf{v}|^2\rangle}, \tag{19}$$

$$\mathbf{j}(\mathbf{k},t) = \frac{1}{N}\sum_i \mathbf{v}_i(t) e^{i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{q}_i(t)}, \qquad C_L(k,t),\, C_T(k,t) \text{ from } \langle j_{L,T}(\mathbf{k},t_0+t)\, j_{L,T}(\mathbf{k},t_0)^*\rangle, \tag{20}$$

$$g_d(r,t) = \frac{V}{N(N-1)} \Big\langle \sum_{i\neq j} \frac{\delta(r - |\mathbf{q}_j(t_0+t) - \mathbf{q}_i(t_0)|_{\mathrm{mi}})}{4\pi r^2} \Big\rangle_{t_0}, \tag{21}$$

where $\langle\cdot\rangle_{t_0}$ is the average over time origins, $|\cdot|_{\mathrm{mi}}$ the minimum-image distance, and the δ function is realised as a histogram divided by the shell volume. Averages without subscript in Z, C_b run over origins and particles (or pairs). The VCCF shells b are $[0, 1.59)$, $[1.59, 2.55)$, $[2.55, L/2)$ (first and second minima of $g(r)$). C_L, C_T are normalised mode by mode by their $t = 0$ values and averaged over the shells $|\mathbf{k}| = 0.899$ (k_1, 3 modes), 1.271 (k_2, 6 modes) and 1.798 (k_4, 3 modes). g_d is evaluated at $t = 0.1, 0.5, 1, 2$; $g_d(r,0) = g(r)$ is shown only. Zero total momentum implies $\sum_{j\neq i} \mathbf{v}_i \cdot \mathbf{v}_j = -|\mathbf{v}_i|^2$, hence each VCCF bin starts at $-1/(N-1) = -0.00392$ if velocities are independent of positions; this is not a per-bin baseline and nothing is subtracted.

Sampling. Two groups of trajectories are analysed separately and never pooled. The *primary group* is the 16 four-level chains of the dt study: common grid 0.01, lags ≤ 2, origins $t_0 \in [1, 8]$ every

0.05. The *secondary group* is the 11 long-D chains (dt 0.005 and 0.01 only): origins $t_0 \in [10, 98]$ every 0.25. The statistical unit is the replica; origins, particles and bins are averaged inside a replica. Curves are normalised by each level's own $t = 0$ value, so these curve verdicts are shape-only, with two exceptions: the "vacf_amp" curve is normalised by the *reference* level's $C(0)$, and the VCCF is normalised by $\langle|\mathbf{v}|^2\rangle$, not by $C_b(0)$, so offsets of $C_b(0)$ enter its differences. Amplitude is otherwise judged through the scalars $C(0)$, $C_L(0)$, $C_T(0)$, whose intervals are per-scalar 97.5% paired Student-t intervals over replicas.

Protocol and error definition. The protocol was frozen before any difference was computed (v2, commit `c0434df`) and amended once (v3, commit `7484b7d`), also before any difference of the new observables was computed (the protocol itself lists two exceptions that were not blind: the $C(0)$-scaled VACF and $g(r)$, whose dt differences had been seen in the earlier dt study): every sign lobe of the reference curve is judged on its own. For each window, $E_{\text{sig}} = \sup|\overline{\Delta}|/S$ with S the amplitude of the lobe containing the point; the difference band is simultaneous at 97.5% over the window (maximum of a re-studentised sign-flip max-t over all 2^{n-1} sign vectors and Bonferroni-t), and the lobe amplitude band is simultaneous at 97.5%, so both hold jointly at $\geq 95\%$. A curve window PASSes if the upper bound of E_{sig} is $\leq 1\%$ and every lobe in it is resolved (relative half-width $\leq 10\%$), FAILs if the lower bound exceeds 1%, and is INCONCLUSIVE otherwise. A synthetic self-test of the 95% band construction gave worst coverage 0.94 (nominal 0.95); the 97.5% setting and windows with 1–12 points were not covered by the self-test. v2 and v3 differ in 2 of 284 cells, both INCONCLUSIVE→FAIL; we report v3 and list v2 separately in the repository. Pointwise t-intervals appear only in figures.

Results. Figures 4 and 5 show the primary group; the secondary group is in Appendix B. The main findings, all at 1% of each feature's own lobe amplitude, are:

- *Display support.* Of 71 observable×window cells, a single cell is SUPPORTED for dt = 0.01 (and the same for 0.005): the van Hove core window at $t = 0.1$, which contains one r bin ($r = 0.84$) where $g_d \approx 0.012$. It says nothing about the van Hove structure. Five cells are NOT SUPPORTED because of FAILs; the other 65 are INCONCLUSIVE.

- *Resolved deviations at dt = 0.01 vs 0.00125.* $\langle|\mathbf{v}|^2\rangle$ is lower by 0.38% [0.09, 0.67] (PASS at 1%); $C_T(k_1)$ decays more slowly for $t \leq 0.5$ (half-decay time +3.6% [+0.6, +6.6]); $g_d(r < 0.9, t = 2)$ differs by $E_{\text{sig}} = 1.9\%$ [0.14, 4.6]. All except $\langle|\mathbf{v}|^2\rangle$ are INCONCLUSIVE against 1%. For the $g_d(t = 2)$ cell the levels 0.0025 and 0.005 give the same offset, which suggests a low reference mean rather than a dt trend; this is not established.

- *FAIL cells.* Seven of 284 cells FAIL (5 of 224 window cells, 2 of 60 whole-curve cells), six involving dt = 0.01 and five in the secondary 0.01 vs 0.005 comparison (VCCF far shell for $t \in (0.2, 0.5]$; $C_L(k_1)$ for $t \in (0.5, 1]$; $C_L(k_2)$ for $t \in (1, 2]$; and the whole-curve cells of the far shell and of $C_L(k_1)$). All lie in windows whose reference lobes are unresolved. One primary FAIL (0.005 vs 0.00125, VCCF second shell, $t \leq 0.2$) appears to be driven mainly by an offset of the shared reference at $t = 0$ ($C_b(0) = -0.00437$, 2.5 replica-SE below $-1/(N-1)$, while all three coarser levels lie 4–5 $\times 10^{-4}$ above it). At this sample size the FAIL counts cannot separate chance from a dt effect; the counts are reported as observed.

- *No whole-curve deviation is resolved in the primary group; this is not equivalence.* The simultaneous upper bounds at dt = 0.01 are 1.0×10^{-2} of $C(0)$ (VACF), 3.2×10^{-3} of $\langle|\mathbf{v}|^2\rangle$

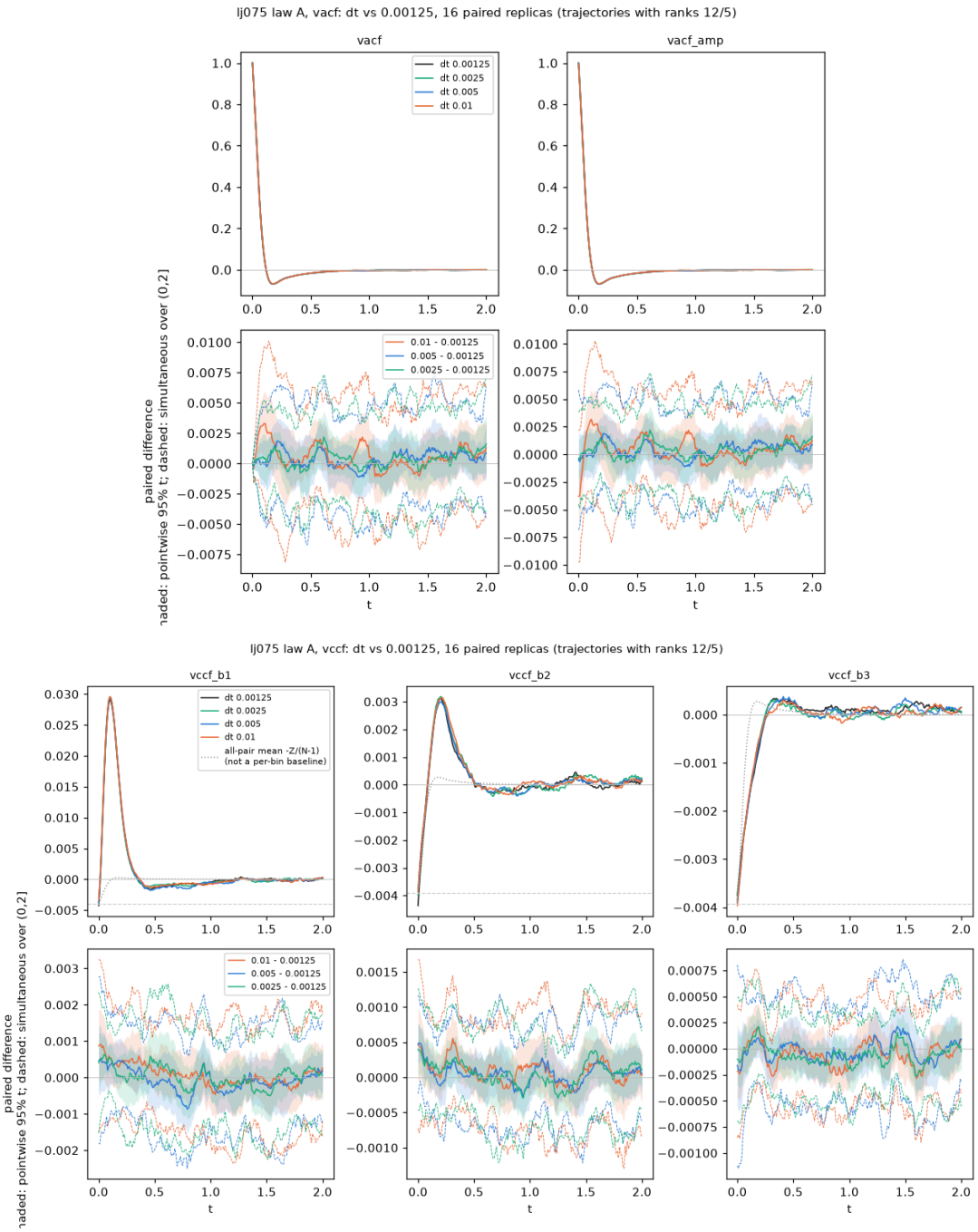


Figure 4: VACF (top; left normalised by each level's $C(0)$, right "vacf_amp" normalised by the reference level's $C(0)$) and distance-conditioned VCCF $C_b(t)$ for the three shells (bottom), LJ+A, $N = 256$, primary group: 16 coupled replicas, dt $\in \{0.00125, 0.0025, 0.005, 0.01\}$, ranks 12/5, origins $t_0 \in [1, 8]$. Upper rows: level means. Lower rows: paired differences against dt $= 0.00125$; shading: pointwise 95% t-interval (not used for verdicts); dashed: simultaneous 97.5% band of the whole-curve cell over $(0, 2]$. Dotted line in the VCCF panels: all-pair mean $-Z/(N-1)$; light dashed line: $-1/(N-1)$; neither is a per-bin baseline. Shading uses $n = 16$; the dashed band is centred on the mean difference and is also drawn at $t = 0$. Source: `lj075_results/observable_dt/{vacf,vccf}_dt.png`, from `results.json` (protocol v3).

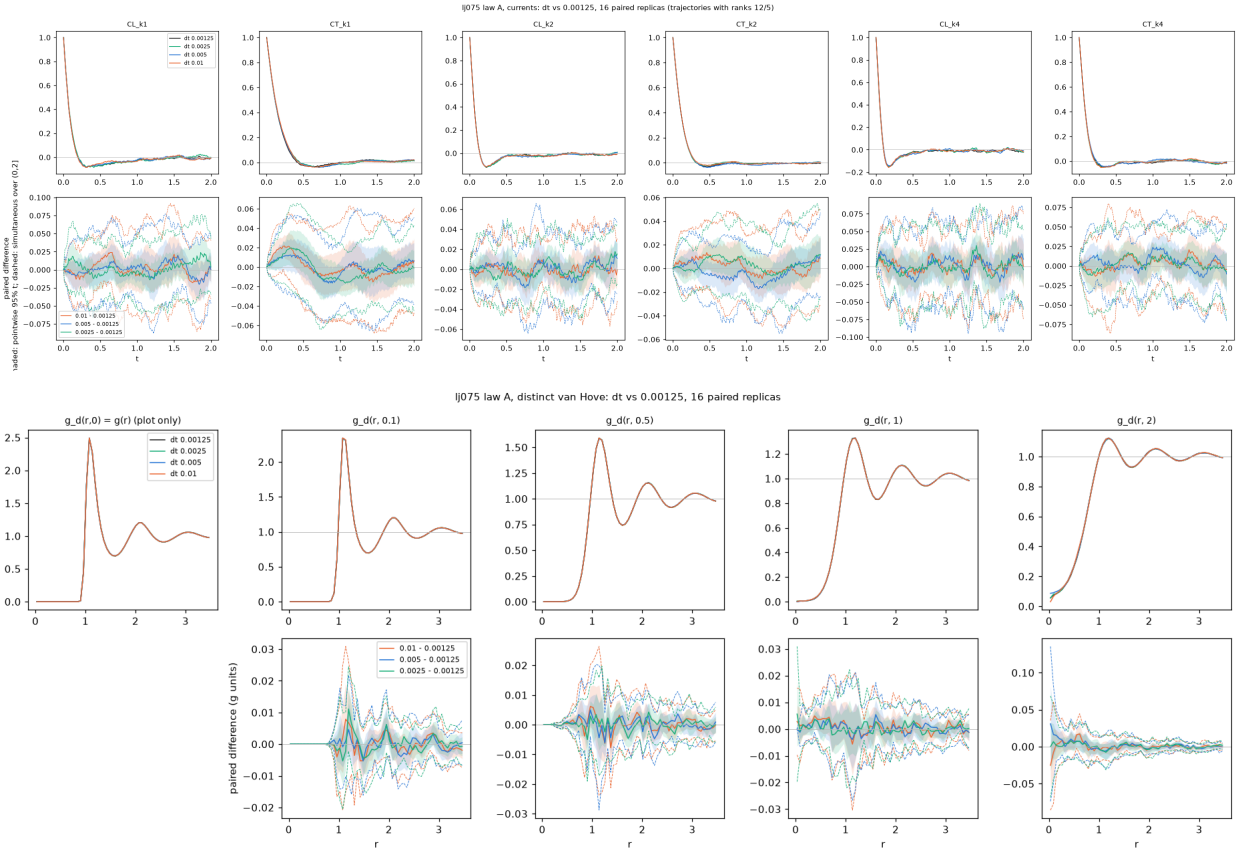


Figure 5: Top: normalised longitudinal and transverse current correlations $C_L(k,t)$, $C_T(k,t)$ at $|\mathbf{k}| = 0.899,\ 1.271,\ 1.798$. Bottom: distinct van Hove function $g_d(r,t)$ at $t = 0, 0.1, 0.5, 1, 2$ ($t = 0$ shown only). Same data, groups, bands and conventions as Figure 4. For g_d the dashed band is simultaneous only over r bins with at least 100 reference pairs per replica (e.g. $r > 0.79$ at $t = 0.1$); it carries no coverage in the excluded small-r bins. Source: `lj075_results/observable_dt/{currents,van_hove}_dt.png`.

Table 4: Production-step cost, LJ+A, $N = 256$, single thread, dt $= 0.005$ (`lj075_results/pppm_cost.json`).

PPPM set	ranks	max $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}}$ (verification set)[a]	ms/step, median [min, max]	core-h per time unit
η 0.6779, p 8 (production)	12/5	7.3×10^{-8}	124.8 [122.4, 130.1]	0.0069
η 0.6779, p 8 (production)	14/5	7.6×10^{-8}	134.9 [133.2, 136.8]	0.0075
η 0.6, p 7	12/5	7.6×10^{-8}	117.9 [113.4, 124.8]	0.0065
s_* 4.4, η 0.6, p 7	12/5	1.6×10^{-8}	140.0 [132.4, 155.6]	0.0078

[a] The two production rows differ only in the state set used for verification (representative for 12/5, equilibration-visited for 14/5), not in the operator.

(first-shell VCCF), 0.092 ($C_L(k_1)$), 0.068 ($C_T(k_1)$) and 0.030/0.045 (g_d at $t = 1, 2$, in g units). Effects up to these sizes are not excluded.

- *Why most cells are undecided.* Weak reference lobes (VACF dip in the primary group, negative lobes of C_L, C_T, second and third VCCF shells, van Hove tails) are not resolved to ±10%, so PASS is impossible there; where lobes are resolved, the difference bands still reach 1.5–8.5% of the lobe amplitude.

- *Secondary group, 0.01 vs 0.005.* D_{GK} to $t = 2$ PASSes on the protocol's integral scale $(1/3)\int_0^2 |C|\,\mathrm{d}t \approx 2.3 D_{\mathrm{GK}}$; relative to D_{GK} itself the difference is $+0.55\%$ $[-0.78, +1.88]$, so 1% agreement of D_{GK} is not shown. The VACF zero crossing and the g_d first-peak excess at $t = 0.1$ also PASS; these are agreements between 0.01 and 0.005 only and cannot by themselves confer display support.

A decay of a correlation function to zero is not used as evidence that the model is correct, and long-lag differences are not attributed to chaos or sampling noise without a test that separates them. A burst design for the $t \leq 0.5$ features (about 170 coupled bursts, 6.8 core-hours) is described in `followup_plan.json` and was not run. Its sizing assumes a true difference of zero, uses the lobe amplitude rather than its lower bound (about 207 rather than 167 bursts for the VACF dip), ignores the lobe-resolution requirement (the primary VACF dip lobe is unresolved, so that cell cannot PASS by more bursts alone), and grows to about 1000–1650 bursts at the differences observed so far.

5.5 Cost

All LJ+A timings below were recorded on the development virtual machine (host "vm"; the CPU model, Xeon 2.80 GHz, is recorded only for the pilot), single thread (OpenBLAS/OMP/MKL threads = 1). Table 4 reports CPU time per step; the dt comparison and the pilot report wall-clock step times. We do not combine them with timings from other machines, and queue or scheduling time never enters.

Production step. The median CPU time of one full BAOAB step (forces, Γ_h build, Lanczos damping and noise) at dt = 0.005, from 6 interleaved rounds of 40 steps, is given in Table 4. Raising the noise rank from 12 to 14 costs +8%. At ranks 14/5, one time unit costs 0.0075 core-hours at dt = 0.005.

dt = 0.01 versus 0.005. In a separate session of interleaved production-runner runs (3 rounds of 300 steps per setting, no frame output), the median per-step cost differed by at most 2.6% between the two step sizes, and the measured saving per physical time of dt = 0.01 over 0.005 was 48.7%

(ranks 12/5) and 50.4% (14/5), consistent with the 50% step-count estimate. These per-step times (0.18–0.20 s) differ from Table 4 because they include the production runner's overhead; the two measurements are not mixed.

Fast versus dense at matched model. The local pilot (Appendix C) timed both O-steps for the same model and state on the same machine, in the same session: median integration-step time 0.208 s (fast, PPPM + Lanczos 14/5) versus 1.129 s (dense Γ_{ref} with eigendecomposition) at dt = 0.005, and 0.204 versus 1.034 s at dt = 0.01; peak resident memory 121 MB versus 604 MB. The accuracy is not matched in the strict sense: the dense step is the model ($\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}} \approx 0$; lattice-sum truncation $\sim 10^{-11}$ per pair), the fast step carries $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{op}} \approx 7 \times 10^{-8}$. The dense step times varied strongly (90th percentile 2.3–2.5 times the median), for reasons not investigated. A same-model comparison of dense, direct-sum and PPPM with operator construction, single $\Gamma\mathbf{v}$ and full step timed separately, at matched accuracy and over $N = 64$–1728, exists only for the earlier toy state point (Appendix D); a size scan at the LJ+A state point has not been run.

5.6 Reproducibility and data scope

Every result file carries a provenance block (command, git commit, dirty flag, script hashes, library versions, thread settings). Raw trajectories of the LJ+A study (`lj075_results/raw/`) are git-ignored and are *not* available in the repository clone used for this draft; their SHA-256 hashes are recorded in `observable_dt/inventory.json`. Consequently: the figures and tables of this paper can be regenerated from cached analysis files (JSON, `per_replica_observables.npz`); any new observable, a different window or a different statistical protocol on the existing trajectories requires the raw files, which must be retrieved from the machine that produced them [TODO: location of raw LJ+A trajectories]. The same holds for the toy trajectories of Appendix D (manifest lists 76 files, 413.8 MB, absent). See `evidence_map.md` for a per-item list.

6 Discussion and limitations

What is established for LJ+A at $\rho^* = 0.75$, $k_{\mathrm{B}}T = 1$, $N = 256$. (a) The structural properties of the model (symmetry, positivity, momentum null space, FDT and invariance of the Gibbs measure) hold for the continuous model and, except positivity, for the PPPM matrix by construction. (b) The PPPM operator meets the 2×10^{-7} budget against the full-periodic lattice-sum matrix on 152 static and visited configurations, and positivity on $\mathrm{Ran}\,\Pi$ holds on all of them. (c) Lanczos ranks 14/5 meet a strict error rule ($\leq 2 \times 10^{-8}$) on all 152 states, with worst error 6.4×10^{-10}. (d) Momentum is carried to round-off. (e) The effect of the operator error on time averages was $\leq 1.3 \times 10^{-4}$ relative in two lock-step replicas. (f) T, U/N, the RDF first peak, the VACF for $t \leq 2$ and MSD(0.1) PASS the registered 1% criteria at all of dt = 0.0025, 0.005 and 0.01.

What is provisional or under-sampled. No time step is validated under the registered rule; dt = 0.005 is provisional. The dt effect on the RDF norm, on MSD at $t \geq 0.5$, on pressure and on the long-time diffusion coefficient is unresolved at $n = 16$ and $n = 11$. The long-time D has no confirmed plateau at the ±2% level. Initial-state independence after burn-in is not verified (2 runs per start type). Most comparisons of the dynamical correlation functions at 1% of lobe amplitude are INCONCLUSIVE; several resolved deviations at dt = 0.01 (kinetic temperature, transverse current at k_1) and seven FAIL cells are reported as observed without a mechanism. The dynamic runs used ranks 12/5, below the later recommendation 14/5; the on-line Lanczos monitor of the

dt-study runs stayed below 4×10^{-10} (overall norm); the equilibration and long-D monitors are not available.

What is not addressed. No size scan at the LJ+A state point (only $N = 256$), so the $O(N \log N)$ scaling is supported only by earlier toy and ideal-gas tests at fixed rank (Appendix D); on frozen random $\kappa = 1$ configurations the adaptive-tolerance rank grew as $N^{0.34}$. No weak-order or strong-order convergence theorem is proved for the scheme with configuration-dependent matrix friction and Lanczos noise; the stationary distribution of the discrete scheme is not characterised. The influence function is not optimised. The cheaper PPPM alternative of Table 2 is verified statically only. No HPC run has been performed: the HPC scripts were exercised by local emulation only (Appendix C). Kernel B was stopped before analysis. There is no external validation against molecular dynamics or experiment, and no reproduction of Ref. [2] is claimed.

Next steps implied by the data. About 25 replicas for MSD(0.5) and 60–100 for pressure at 1%; about 16–60 runs of 100 time units to confirm a ±2% plateau of D; about 170 coupled short bursts for the $t \le 0.5$ correlation features; a size scan with the 14/5 configuration; the cluster pilot. None of these were run for this draft.

A Proofs and closed forms

A.1 Closed form of ρ_κ

With $a = \kappa^2/4$,

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}s}\Big[2\sqrt{\tfrac{s}{\pi}}\,e^{-a/s}\Big] = w_\kappa(s) + \frac{\kappa^2}{2\sqrt{\pi}} s^{-3/2} e^{-a/s}, \qquad \frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}s}\Big[-\kappa\,\mathrm{erfc}\Big(\frac{\kappa}{2\sqrt{s}}\Big)\Big] = -\frac{\kappa^2}{2\sqrt{\pi}} s^{-3/2} e^{-a/s}.$$

The sum is w_κ; both terms vanish as $s \to 0^+$. Positivity follows from $\rho_\kappa = \int_0^s w_\kappa > 0$. For numerical stability the code evaluates the algebraically identical form $\rho_\kappa = \frac{2\sqrt{s}}{\sqrt{\pi}} e^{-a/s}\, p(\kappa/(2\sqrt{s}))$, $p(x) = 1 - \sqrt{\pi} x\,\mathrm{erfcx}(x)$, and checks it against the literal expression.

A.2 Hessian representation and E_1 closed forms

For each $s > 0$, $\partial_i \partial_j e^{-sr^2} = (4s^2 x_i x_j - 2s\delta_{ij}) e^{-sr^2}$, hence $x_i x_j e^{-sr^2} = \frac{1}{4s^2}\partial_i\partial_j e^{-sr^2} + \frac{\delta_{ij}}{2s} e^{-sr^2}$. Multiplying by $\rho_\kappa(s)$ and integrating over any s-interval I gives $\mathbf{r}\mathbf{r}^\mathsf{T} \int_I \rho_\kappa e^{-sr^2} = \nabla\nabla\varphi_I + \psi_I \mathbf{I}$ with the restricted integrals; differentiation under the integral is justified for $r > 0$ since $\rho_\kappa(s)/s^2 = O(s^{-3/2})$ at infinity and $O(s^{-1/2} e^{-\kappa^2/4s})$ at zero. For $I = (0, \infty)$: $\partial_{(r^2)}\psi_\kappa = -\frac{1}{2}\int \rho_\kappa e^{-sr^2} = -\frac{e^{-\kappa r}}{2r^3}$, so $\psi_\kappa'(r) = -e^{-\kappa r}/r^2$ and, with $\psi_\kappa(\infty) = 0$, $\psi_\kappa(r) = \int_r^\infty e^{-\kappa t} t^{-2}\,\mathrm{d}t = e^{-\kappa r}/r - \kappa E_1(\kappa r)$. Similarly $\varphi_\kappa'(r) = -r\psi_\kappa(r)$, and using $\int u E_1(u)\,\mathrm{d}u = \frac{u^2}{2}E_1(u) - \frac{(u+1)e^{-u}}{2}$, $\varphi_\kappa(r) = \int_r^\infty t\psi_\kappa(t)\,\mathrm{d}t = \frac{1}{2\kappa}[(1 - x)e^{-x} + x^2 E_1(x)]$, $x = \kappa r$. Note $\varphi_\kappa(0) = 1/(2\kappa)$ is finite while $\psi_\kappa(r) \sim 1/r$ as $r \to 0$. Numerical checks: see Remark 3.2 (script `manuscript/scripts/verify_closed_forms.py`).

A.3 Fourier transform of the full kernel

By isotropy, $\hat{K}_\kappa(\mathbf{k}) = a(k)\mathbf{I} + b(k)\hat{\mathbf{k}}\hat{\mathbf{k}}^\mathsf{T}$ with $3a + b = \int e^{-i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{r}} e^{-\kappa r}/r\,\mathrm{d}\mathbf{r} = 4\pi/(k^2 + \kappa^2)$. The transverse part is $a(k) = 4\pi \int_0^\infty r e^{-\kappa r} \frac{j_1(kr)}{kr}\,\mathrm{d}r = \frac{4\pi}{k^3} I(k)$ with $I(k) = \int_0^\infty e^{-\kappa r} \frac{\sin kr - kr\cos kr}{r^2}\,\mathrm{d}r$. Differentiating, $I'(k) = k\int_0^\infty e^{-\kappa r}\sin kr\,\mathrm{d}r = \frac{k^2}{k^2+\kappa^2}$, $I(0) = 0$, so $I(k) = k - \kappa\arctan(k/\kappa)$. Thus (7)

with $\lambda_{\parallel} = a + b = 4\pi/(k^2 + \kappa^2) - 2a$. As $k \to 0$, $a \to 4\pi/(3\kappa^2)$, consistent with (5). Numerical check against radial quadrature at $k \in \{0.05, 0.9, 1.3, 4\}$, $\kappa = 0.7$: relative error $\leq 7.2 \times 10^{-10}$.

A.4 Stationarity of the Gibbs measure

See the proof of Proposition 2.4; the friction part of the Fokker–Planck operator is $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{fr}}^{*}\pi = \nabla_{\mathbf{p}} \cdot [\Gamma(\mathbf{q})(\frac{\mathbf{p}}{m}\pi + k_{\mathrm{B}}T\nabla_{\mathbf{p}}\pi)]$, which vanishes for $\pi \propto e^{-|\mathbf{p}|^2/(2mk_{\mathrm{B}}T)}$. This is the same mechanism as in dissipative particle dynamics [1].

B Additional figures for the LJ+A study

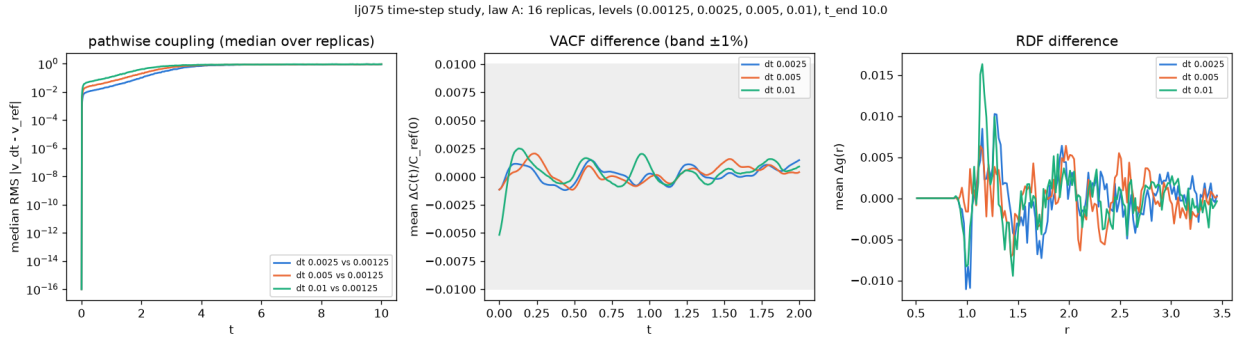


Figure 6: dt study, LJ+A, 16 coupled replicas, levels 0.00125–0.01, $t_{\mathrm{end}} = 10$, ranks 12/5. Left: median over replicas of the RMS velocity difference to the 0.00125 path. Middle: mean VACF difference (grey: ±1% band). Right: mean RDF difference. Middle and right panels show means only, without intervals; verdicts use Table 3. Source: `lj075_results/dt_study_A.png`.

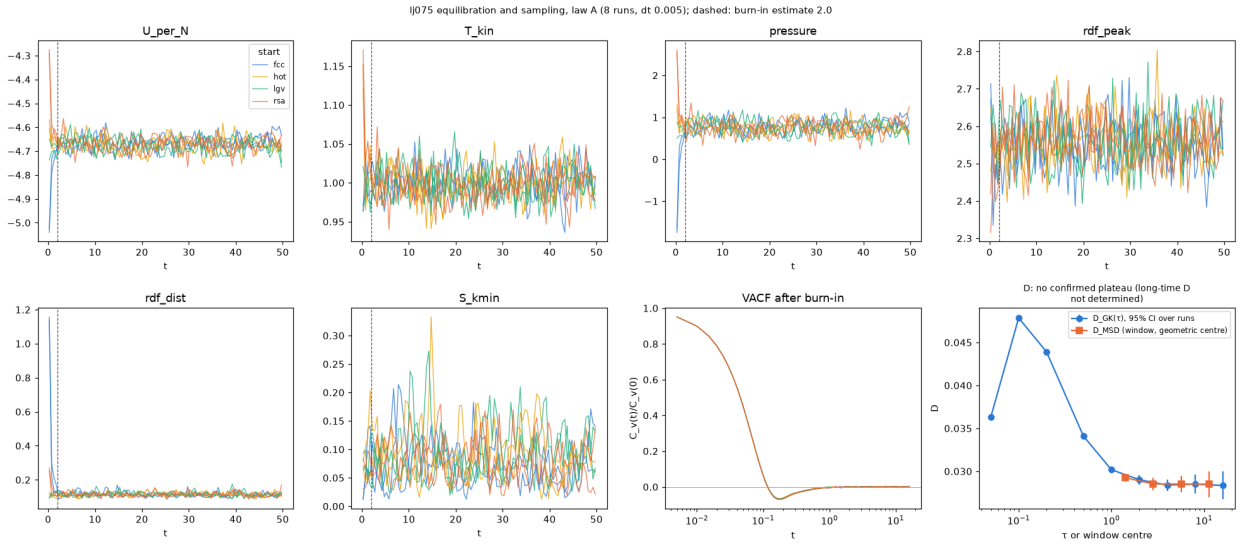


Figure 7: Equilibration, LJ+A, 8 runs of 50 time units at dt = 0.005 (ranks 12/5), four start types (two runs each); dashed line: measured burn-in 2.0. Bottom right: $D_{\mathrm{GK}}(\tau)$ and windowed D_{MSD} with 95% CIs over the 8 runs; no plateau is confirmed. Source: `lj075_results/equilibration_A.png`.

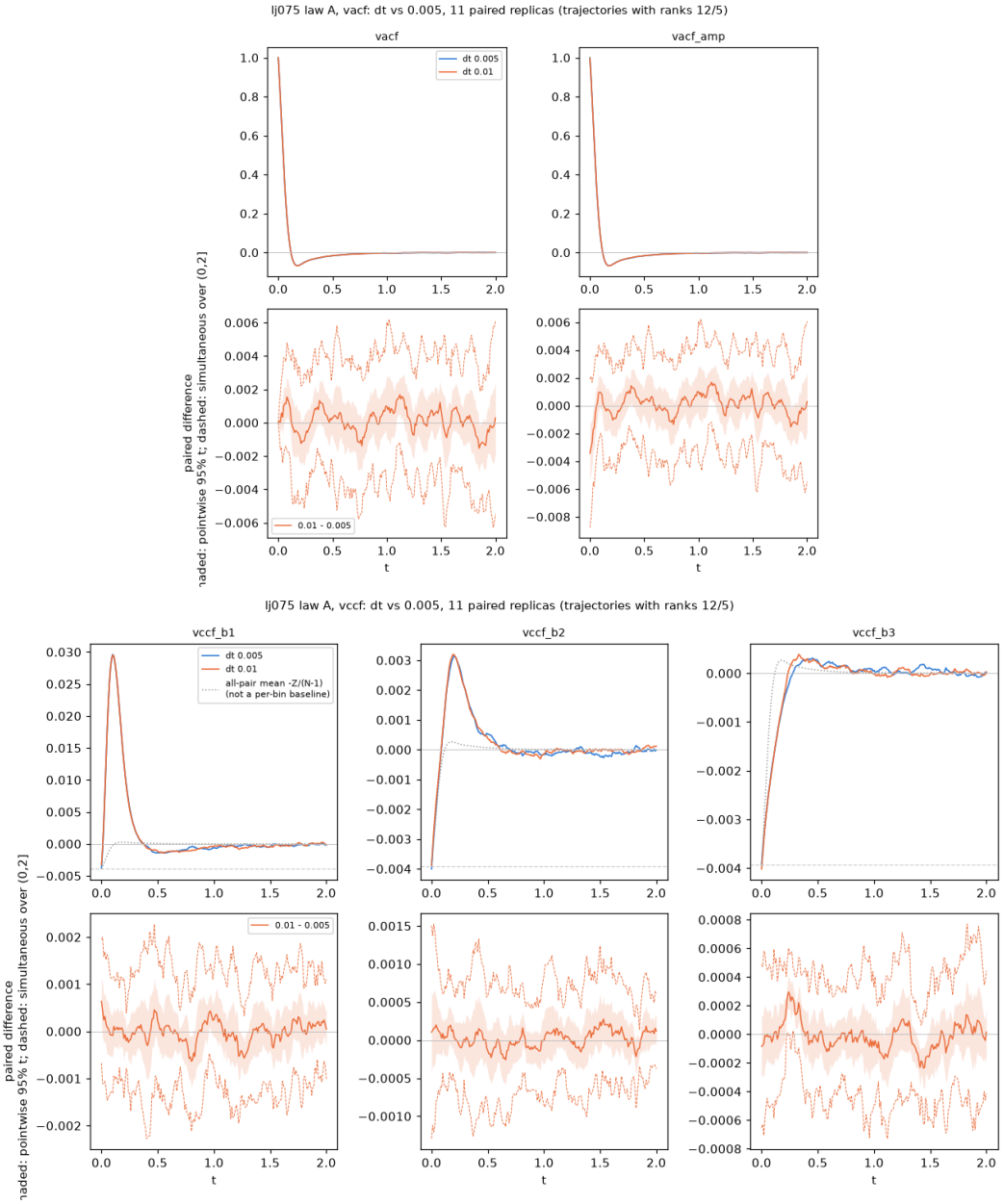


Figure 8: Secondary group, VACF and VCCF: 11 coupled two-level chains, dt = 0.01 versus 0.005 only, origins $t_0 \in [10, 98]$ every 0.25, ranks 12/5. Same layout and band conventions as Figure 4. This group holds five of the seven FAIL cells; it cannot confer display support because it has no finer reference level. Source: `lj075_results/observable_dt/{vacf,vccf}_dt_secondary.png` (drawn from stored means and paired differences in `results.json`).

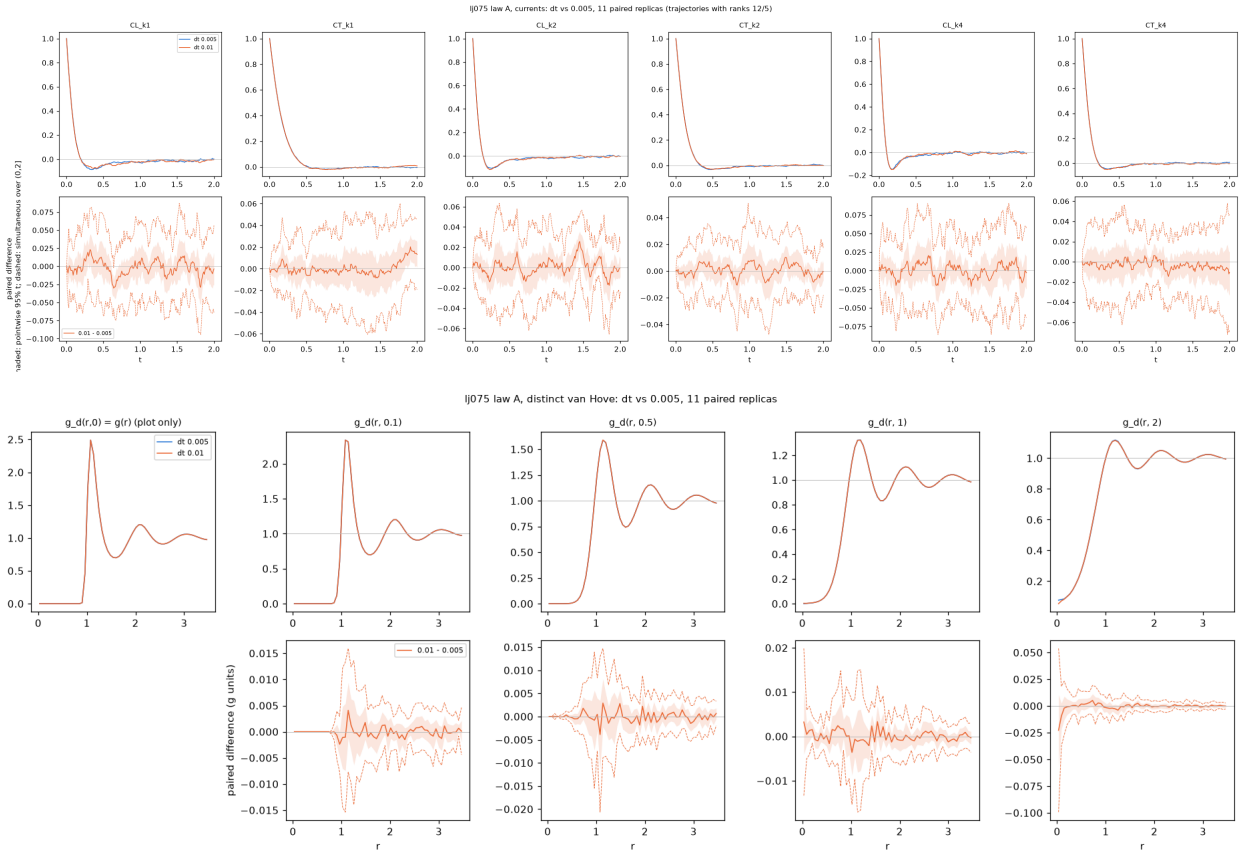


Figure 9: Secondary group, current correlations and distinct van Hove function; data and conventions as in Figure 8 and Figure 5. Source: `lj075_results/observable_dt/{currents,van_hove}_dt_secondary.png`.

C Local emulation of the HPC pilot

The HPC workflow (Slurm scripts, checkpoint/restart, locking) was exercised *locally* with bash on the development VM, without Slurm (`hpc_pilot/local_20261010`; `on_slurm=false`, no job IDs). It is *not* a cluster result, and no newer cluster result exists in the repository. Setup: configuration `lj_rho0.75_kT1.0_A_prod`; fast O-step = PPPM + Lanczos 14/5; dense O-step = Γ_{ref} with dense eigendecomposition; dt = 0.005 (200 steps) and 0.01 (100 steps) to $t = 1$; one initial state (step 10000 of equilibration run s305, which used ranks 12/5); fast and dense share the noise at each dt; the two dt values are not coupled; one thread.

All workflow checks passed (three-segment restart bitwise equal to a continuous twin, lock refusal, checkpoint cadence, every-step frames; Lanczos monitor self-estimate below 4.9×10^{-11} against the budget 2×10^{-7}). Fast−dense differences at $t = 1$: RMS position $1.96\times10^{-8}/2.22\times10^{-8}$, RMS velocity $1.28\times10^{-7}/1.35\times10^{-7}$ ($7.4\times10^{-8}/7.8\times10^{-8}$ of the RMS velocity) for dt = 0.005/0.01; $\max_t |\Delta T_{\mathrm{kin}}| \le 1.3\times10^{-8}$. $|P(t)-P(0)| \le 1.3\times10^{-13}$ in all four cases. The difference is dominated by the PPPM operator error (relative Frobenius 4.1–4.3×10^{-8}), not by Lanczos truncation. Fitted growth rates of the differences over $[0.1, 1]$ (1.45–2.42) are fits, not Lyapunov exponents. The value 4.9×10^{-11} is the maximum of the run monitor's self-estimates $\|f_r - f_{r+e}\|/\|f_{r+e}\|$ over four columns (noise and damping, full and $k_{\min}$-projected; `toy_run.MON_COLS`); which column attains it cannot be recovered because the raw monitor files are not in the repository. The actual noise-function Lanczos error, against the dense matrix function of the same Γ_h on the monitor's own random input, is $\le 4.3\times10^{-12}$ (damping $\le 1.5\times10^{-11}$; `pilot_results.json`, key `lanczos_check`).

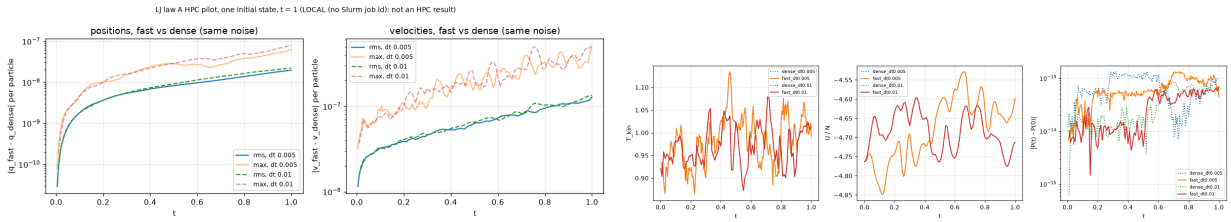


Figure 10: Local emulation of the HPC pilot (not run on HPC), LJ+A, $N = 256$, one state, one paired noise path per dt, $t \le 1$. Left: per-particle fast−dense position and velocity differences (RMS and max). Right: T_{kin}, U/N and $|P(t) - P(0)|$ for the four cases. No error bars (single path). Source: `hpc_pilot/local_20261010/pilot_{fast_vs_dense,diagnostics}.png`.

D Historical and auxiliary evidence (not the main model)

The following studies used other systems. They support the algorithmic components within their own scope and are *not* verification of the LJ+A state point. "Config A/B" in the Lanczos studies denotes two frozen random configurations, not the kernels.

Table 5: Earlier studies and their scope.

directory	system	main result (scope)
`results/`, `figures/`	unit kernel, $\kappa = \xi = 1$; random configs $N = 30$, $L = 6$ and $N = 40$, $L = 10$	split error 3.6×10^{-15} (scalar), 1.9×10^{-15} (tensor); Γ_{full}, Γ_S, Γ_L PSD; periodic convolution with $\hat{K}_L$ not PSD; Fourier-truncated Γ_L indefinite at small k_c
`parameter_selection_results/`	same, $\kappa = 1$	balanced rule $\xi r_c = k_c/(2\xi) = s_*$; $\epsilon_S/e^{-s_*^2} = 0.34$–$0.79$, $\epsilon_F/e^{-s_*^2} = 0.18$–$0.44$; mesh transfer error floors accuracy near 10^{-5} at $\eta = 0.7$, $p = 4$
`equal_accuracy_xi_results/`	same, plus $N = 4000$ timing	at tolerance 10^{-7}, one Γ_h action at $N = 4000$: 332, 311, 532, 1366, 8145 ms for $\xi = 0.5, 0.7, 1, 1.4, 2$ (machine not recorded)
`mesh_error_decomposition_results/`	$\kappa = \xi = 1$, 13 195 mesh operators	deconvolution error at round-off; alias terms 0.92–1.03 of the mesh error; slopes $p - 0.1$ to $p + 1.55$ (superseded by Appendix D.2)
`radial_kernel_static_results/`	toy state $N = 64$, $L = 5.5$, $k_{\text{B}}T = 0.7$; kernels A and B	$\varepsilon_{\text{op}} = 1.27 \times 10^{-7}$ (LJ, A, $p = 7$); $k = 0$ share of $\|\Gamma\|$ 0.377; removing $k = 0$ gives $\lambda_{\min} = -0.867$
`lanczos_fdt_results/`	unit kernel $\kappa = 1$, $\rho = 30/216$, frozen configs; PPPM $\xi = 0.7$, $s_* = 4.1$, $\eta = 0.7$, $p = 7$	median rank at 10^{-8}: 25 (config A), 48 (config B); rank $\propto N^{0.34}$ up to $N = 4000$; adaptive-tolerance cost $\propto N^{1.43}$; stopping rule $d_1 \leq \text{tol}/10$ had no false stops
`lanczos_range_start_results/`	same	range start needs 1.13–1.43× more rank, 20–35% slower; direct start adopted
`fixed_rank_budget_results/`	same, $N \leq 16000$	rank 40: max error 9.1×10^{-4} at $N = 16000$ against a rank-360 reference (thin margin to 10^{-3})
`dynamics_results/`	ideal gas, $\kappa = 1$, A–O–A, $N = 64$–16000	rank-40 vs dense $\leq 1.0 \times 10^{-9}$ (N=64); production step 0.79/6.35/37.4 s at $N = 512/4000/16000$ (rank 40/16)
`toy_fixed_time_results/`	double well, kernel A, $N = 64$, 5 states × 16 paths	fast−dense 95% bounds $\leq 2 \times 10^{-5}$
`toy_dynamics_results/`	LJ and double well, kernels A, B, $N = 64$, $t = 60$	momentum $\leq 1.1 \times 10^{-12}$; unexplained seed-paired D_{GK} difference +8.0% [4.1, 12.0] (double well, A); raw trajectories absent
`cost_optimization_results/`, `fft_vs_direct_results/`	toy state, double well, $p = 7$ sets	full-step crossover PPPM vs direct periodic sum: $108 < N \leq 256$ (A), $64 < N \leq 108$ (B); at $N = 1728$ PPPM ×7.9–9.9 (A) faster than direct sum, ×12–21 than dense (2.10 GHz Xeon, 1 thread)

D.1 Kernel B (stopped)

Law B, $g(r) = c_B r\, e^{-\kappa r}$ with $c_B = \gamma e^{\kappa r_{\text{ref}}}/r_{\text{ref}}$, has Gaussian-scale weight w_κ instead of ρ_κ. At the LJ state point it was verified statically on 42 states ($\varepsilon_{\text{op}} \leq 2.4 \times 10^{-8}$ full norm, 1.4×10^{-7} relative to the $k \neq 0$ part, which exceeds its 5×10^{-8} budget under that definition; a tighter set passes both). The campaign was stopped at the user's request; dynamic runs exist only as raw data and were not analysed.

Table 6: Parameters of the earlier studies (n/r: not recorded in the result files). "Exp1" is the newer $\kappa = 1$ operator study of Appendix D.2; the LJ+A production row is repeated for contrast. Amplitudes: kernel A $c = 1.615$, kernel B 0.956, unit kernel 1.

study	N	L / density	$k_{\mathrm{B}}T$	potential	kernel, κ	PPPM ξ / s_* / η / p	rank (n/d)	machine
`results/`, `parameter_selection_results/`	30, 40 (4000 timing)	$L = 6$, 10 (30)	–	static	unit, 1	$\xi = 1$ (scan 0.5–2), s_* 2.5–5, η 0.3–0.8, p 2–8	dense	n/r
`equal_accuracy_xi_results/`	30, 40, 4000	as above	–	static	unit, 1	ξ 0.5–2, per-tolerance search	–	n/r
`mesh_error_decomposition_results/`	30, 40	$L = 6$, 10	–	static	unit, 1	$\xi = 1$, k_c 4/6, p 2–8	–	n/r
`radial_kernel_static_results/`	64	$L = 5.5$	0.7	LJ, DW, uniform	A, B; 0.7	0.7 / 4.1 / 0.7 / 7 ($M = 15$)	40/16	n/r
`lanczos_fdt_results/`, `lanczos_range_start_results/`, `fixed_rank_budget_results/`	128–16000	$\rho = 30/216$	1	frozen random	unit, 1	0.7 / 4.1 / 0.7 / 7	adaptive; 16–48	n/r
`dynamics_results/`	64–16000	$\rho = 30/216$	1	ideal gas	unit, 1	0.7 / 4.1 / 0.7 / 7	40/12, 48/16	1 thread, CPU n/r
`toy_fixed_time_results/`, `toy_dynamics_results/`	64	$L = 5.5$	0.7	DW; LJ and DW	A (and B); 0.7	0.7 / 4.1 / 0.7 / 7	40/16	n/r
`cost_optimization_results/`	64–4096	$64/5.5^3$	0.7	DW	A, B; 0.7	A at 2×10^{-7}: 0.85 / 4.1 / 0.678 / 7	32/4 (A)	Xeon 2.30 GHz, 1 thread
`fft_vs_direct_results/`	64–1728	$64/5.5^3$	0.7	DW	A, B; 0.7	high-accuracy sets of the cost study	32/5–64/5 (A)	Xeon 2.10 GHz, 1 thread
Exp1 (`exp1_results/`)	30–256	see Table 7	–	static	unit, 1	T5/T7/T9, Table 8	dense	host "vm", 1 thread
law B at LJ point	256	$\rho^* = 0.75$	1	LJ	B; 0.7	1.0 / 3.9 / 0.683 / 7	–	host "vm"
LJ+A production	256	$\rho^* = 0.75$	1	LJ	A; 0.7	0.85 / 4.1 / 0.6779 / 8 ($M = 24$)	12/5 used, 14/5 rec.	host "vm"

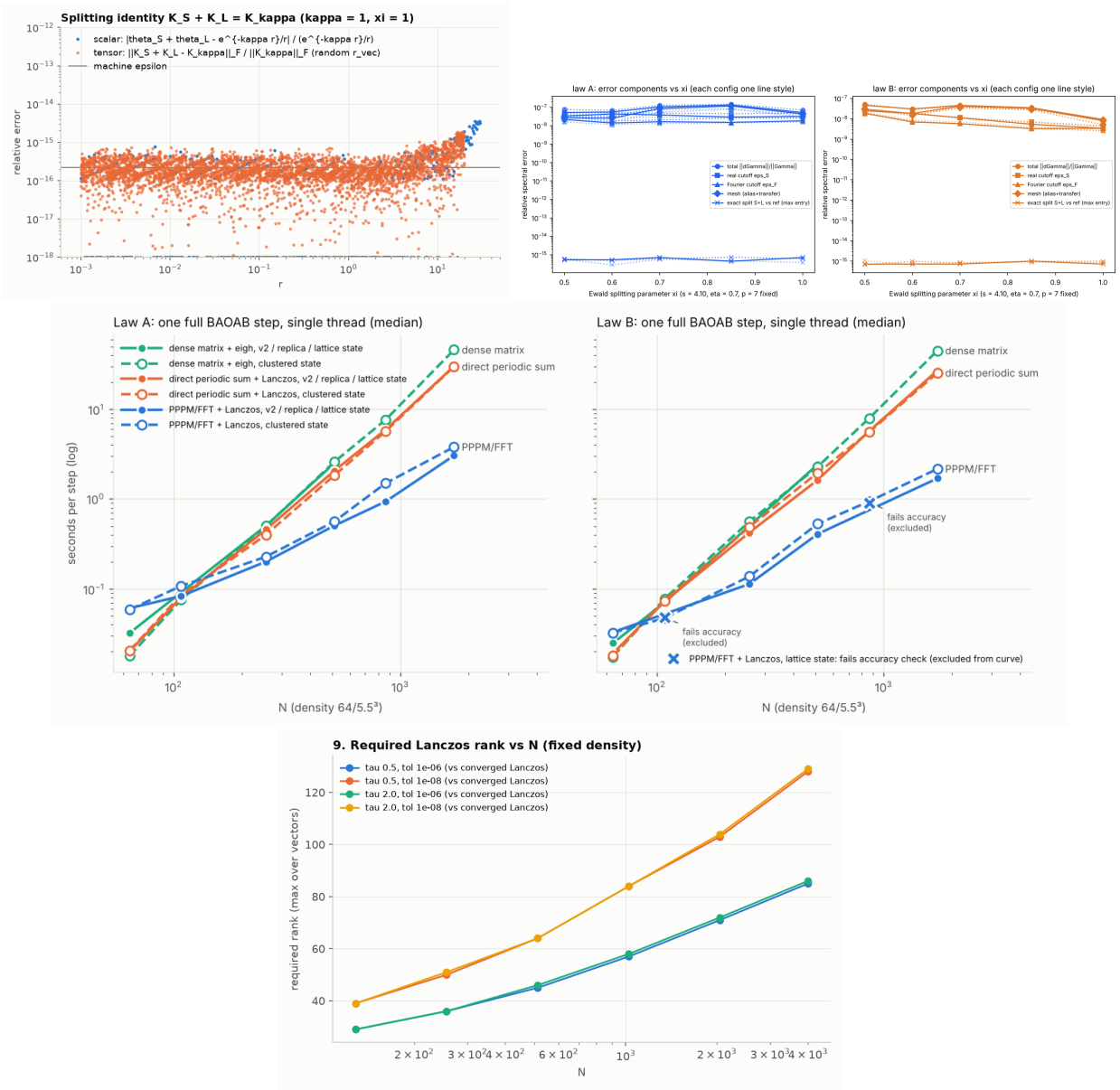


Figure 11: Historical evidence, *not* at the LJ+A state point. Top left: Ewald splitting error, unit kernel $\kappa = \xi = 1$ (`figures/fig1_splitting_error.png`). Top right: PPPM error budget versus ξ at the toy state ($N = 64$, $L = 5.5$, $k_{\mathrm{B}}T = 0.7$; `radial_kernel_static_results/fig1_error_budget_vs_xi.png`). Middle: full BAOAB step time versus N at the toy density $64/5.5^3$ with double-well forces: dense matrix + eigendecomposition, direct periodic sum + Lanczos, PPPM + Lanczos; single thread, median; points failing the accuracy check are excluded (`fft_vs_direct_results/step_time_vs_N.png`). Bottom: required Lanczos rank versus N for the unit kernel at $\rho = 30/216$ (`lanczos_fdt_results/plot09_rank_vs_N.png`).

D.2 Operator-level verification on the unit kernel (Experiment 1, $\kappa = 1$)

This study is the most recent and most complete check of the spatial operator, but it is *not* at the LJ+A state point: the kernel is the unit-amplitude K_κ with $\kappa = 1$, the configurations are static and synthetic, and the PPPM sets use $\xi = 0.7$ (Table 8), not the production set of Section 5.1. It supersedes the $\kappa = 1$ operator checks in `results/`, `parameter_selection_results/` and `mesh_error_decomposition_results/` as evidence for the error components of Section 3.5. Source: `exp1_results/` (`summary.json` and CSV files), scripts `exp1_operator_action.py`, `exp1_plots.py`; these were produced on the remote branch (commits `7b8049f`–`8777731`, merged into this branch).

Configurations and reference. Table 7 lists the 44 configurations: the two original test boxes (A, B), three families at $N = 128$ and $N = 256$ at the density $n_A = 30/216$ of case A (uniform, perturbed bcc/fcc lattice, clustered), and two box-length sets. Γ_{ref} is the unsplit periodic lattice sum over images $|\mathbf{r}_{ij} + \mathbf{n}L| \le R$, with nothing removed (so $k = 0$ is included). Increasing R from 15 to 45, the largest change relative to $R = 45$ is 2.5×10^{-12} at $R = 30$, 2.0×10^{-14} at $R = 35$ and 4.3×10^{-16} at $R = 40$ (spectral norm relative to $\|\Gamma_{\text{ref}}\|_2$); $R = 45$ is used.

Table 7: Static configurations of Experiment 1 ($\kappa = 1$, so $L = \kappa L$). $n = N/L^3$; $d_{\min}$ is the smallest periodic pair distance (range over seeds). Source: `exp1_results/configs.csv`.

set	generation	N	L	n	$d_{\min}$	seeds
A	uniform, seed 7	30	6	0.139	0.395	1
B	uniform, seed 13	40	10	0.040	0.589	1
U128	uniform i.i.d.	128	9.73	0.139	0.142–0.411	3
L128	bcc 4^3, $\sigma = 0.1\, d_{\text{nn}}$	128	9.73	0.139	1.208–1.366	3
C128	clusters of 16, $\sigma_c = 0.5$, $d \ge 0.25$	128	9.73	0.139	0.251–0.255	3
U256	uniform i.i.d.	256	12.3	0.139	0.148	1
L256	fcc 4^3, $\sigma = 0.1\, d_{\text{nn}}$	256	12.3	0.139	1.011	1
C256	clusters of 16, $\sigma_c = 0.5$, $d \ge 0.25$	256	12.3	0.139	0.259	1
box-N	uniform i.i.d.	64	4–16 (6 values)	0.016–1.00	0.090–0.723	3
box-n	uniform i.i.d.	30–240	6–12 (4 values)	0.139	0.055–0.924	3

Table 8: PPPM sets of Experiment 1, accepted at $\xi = 0.7$ for relative tolerances 10^{-5}, 10^{-7}, 10^{-9} on cases A and B. M is the next $2,3,5$-smooth mesh size with $h \le \eta_N \pi / k_c$. Source: `exp1_results/action.csv`.

set	ξ	s_*	r_c	k_c	η_N, p	M (A / B / $N=128$ / $N=256$)
T5	0.7	3.494	4.991	4.891	0.8, 6	12 / 20 / 20 / 24
T7	0.7	4.100	5.857	5.740	0.7, 7	16 / 27 / 27 / 36
T9	0.7	4.628	6.611	6.479	0.6, 8	24 / 36 / 36 / 45

Error components, each measured alone. (i) *Split identity.* With θ_S in closed form and θ_L from its own s-integral, $\theta_S + \theta_L = e^{-\kappa r}/r$ holds to 2.5×10^{-15} for $\xi \in \{0.5, 0.7, 1, 1.4, 2\}$; at operator level, Γ_S (real-space lattice sum) plus the mesh-free Fourier lattice sum of $\hat{K}_L$ (including $\mathbf{k} = 0$) reproduces Γ_{ref} to 1.4×10^{-16}–1.1×10^{-15}. (A first run gave a floor of 2.3×10^{-14}–1.5×10^{-13}; it came from evaluating $A(k), B(k)$ at $|\mathbf{k}|$ rounded to twelve decimals, a bug fixed in commit `8777731`. The remaining floor mixes float64 round-off, up to 6.7×10^{-16} against an 80-bit sum,

with the uncertainty of the image-sum reference, up to 4.3×10^{-16} between $R = 40$ and 45.) (ii) *Truncation.* Fitting $\log E = a - cx^2$ with $x = \xi r_c$ or $k_c/(2\xi)$ gives median rates $c = 0.99$ (real space, range 0.98–1.03) and 0.97 (Fourier, 0.96–1.00) at $\xi = 0.7$ and $\xi = 1$, consistent with the $e^{-s_*^2}$ balance of (14); the algebraic prefactor of the operator-norm error is not that of the continuum tail. (iii) *Mesh.* Against the mesh-free sum over the same modes, the fitted slopes on the four finest meshes, $\eta \approx 0.23$–0.50, are consistent with an h^p trend (median slopes 3.09, 4.07, 5.24, 6.19, 7.46, 8.50 for $p = 3, \ldots, 8$) and faster on coarser meshes (1.1–1.3 p); finite-mesh fits do not establish the asymptotic order. Over eight random grid shifts the maximum error is at most 1.30 times the RMS. In an exact alias decomposition the linear cross terms between the principal term and the aliases carry 0.996–1.003 of the mesh error and the alias–alias term at most 0.9%; the deconvolution error is at most 4.3×10^{-9} of it.

The complete production action. Applying the production spread–FFT–influence–gather code with the degree correction to the $3N$ unit vectors gives Γ_h column by column; it agrees with an independent mode-space assembly to 1.1×10^{-15}, so ε_S, ε_F and $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{mesh}}$ telescope to the production error. Cases A and B meet their tolerances, as selected; uniform and clustered configurations at $N = 128$, 256 meet them. In all, 13 of the 72 (configuration, set) pairs exceed the tolerance, by up to a factor 2.5: the perturbed lattices at all three sets (T7: 1.94–2.11 $\times 10^{-7}$ at $N = 128$), and one uniform box with the size and density of case A at T7 (1.40×10^{-7}). Much of this comes from the normalisation: at T7 the absolute error $\|\Gamma_h - \Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2$ lies in 5.7×10^{-8}–5.5×10^{-7} over all 44 configurations, whereas $\|\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2$ ranges over 0.72–35. Close pairs strongly influence $\|\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2$, but the nearest pair alone does not set it ($\|\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2/\theta(d_{\min}) = 2.0$–$4.1$; an isolated pair gives 2), and the absolute error itself varies with the configuration by about a factor ten. A tolerance relative to $\|\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2$ calibrated on cases A and B therefore does not, in general, transfer to other configurations. Probe vectors at the lowest wave number $2\pi/L$ have relative action errors up to 14 (longitudinal) and 18 (transverse) times the configuration's relative spectral error, because $\|\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}} X\|/(\|\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2 \|X\|)$ is small for such modes. Among the configurations within the operator tolerance, the largest relative action error is 4.5 times the tolerance at T7 and 4.9 times at T9. $\Gamma_h T_\alpha = 0$ exactly in floating point, Γ_h is symmetric to 1.0×10^{-16}, and $\|\Gamma_h - \Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}\|_2 < \lambda_{\min}(\Gamma_{\mathrm{ref}}|_{\mathrm{Ran}\,\Pi})$ in every case.

Relevance for LJ+A. The configuration dependence of the relative error is consistent with what was observed at the LJ+A point, where the $p = 7$ set inherited from the toy state failed the budget on fcc-lattice states (Section 5.1); for this reason the LJ+A operator was verified on its own representative and visited states (Section 5.2) rather than on transferred calibrations. Experiment 1 was not repeated at $\kappa = 0.7$ with the production set.

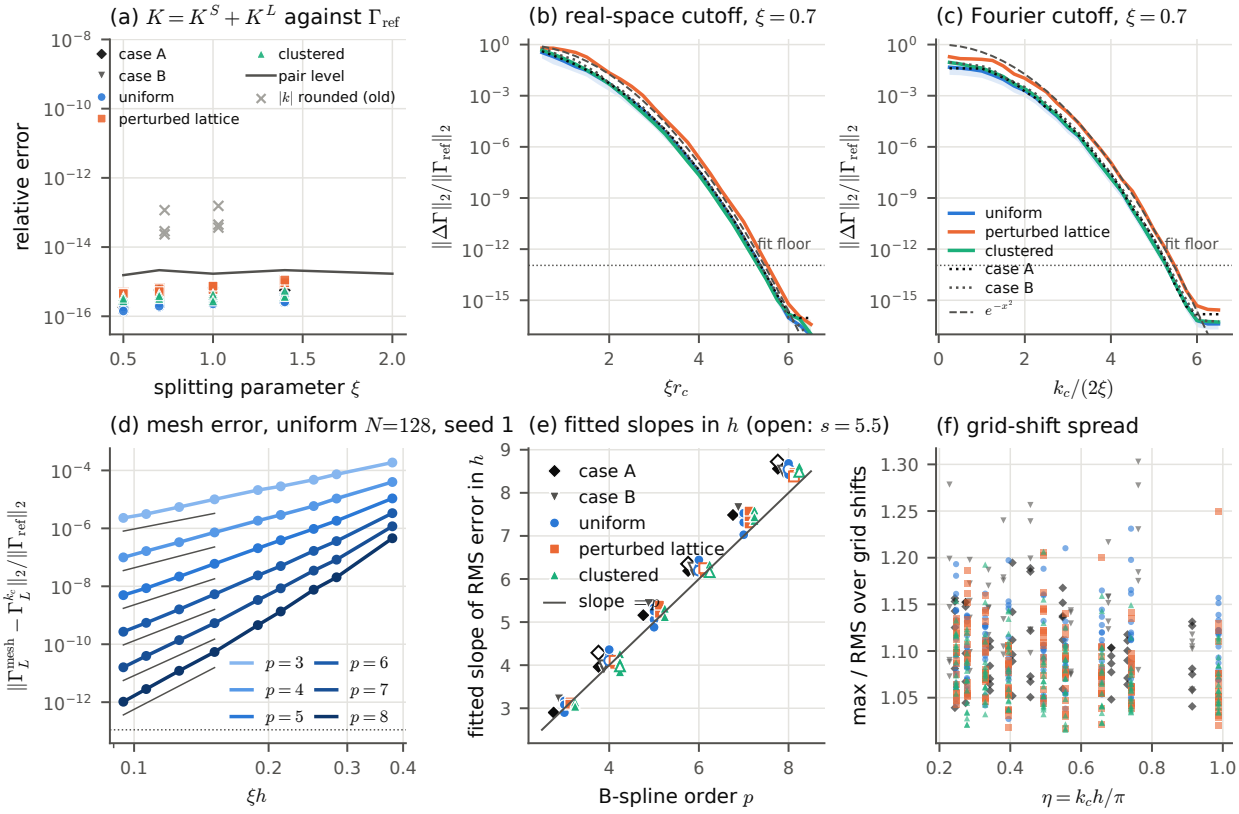


Figure 12: Experiment 1 ($\kappa = 1$, unit amplitude, static configurations of Table 7; *not* LJ+A). (a) Split identity at operator level against Γ_{ref}; line: pair-level error; grey crosses: the earlier Fourier sum with $|\mathbf{k}|$ rounded to twelve decimals (a bug, since fixed). (b) Real-space and (c) Fourier truncation at $\xi = 0.7$ alone; curves: median over three seeds, bands: range over seeds; dotted curves: cases A, B; dashed: e^{-x^2}; dotted horizontal line: fit floor 1.1×10^{-13}. (d) Mesh error against the mesh-free sum over the same modes, $k_c = 5.74$, uniform $N = 128$ seed 1; curves: RMS over eight grid shifts, bands: range over shifts, thin segments: slope p. (e) Fitted slopes in h on the four finest meshes (filled: $s_* = 4.1$; open: $s_* = 5.5$, five configurations). (f) Max over RMS error across eight grid shifts. Source: `exp1_results/figures/exp1_components.pdf` (commit `8777731`).

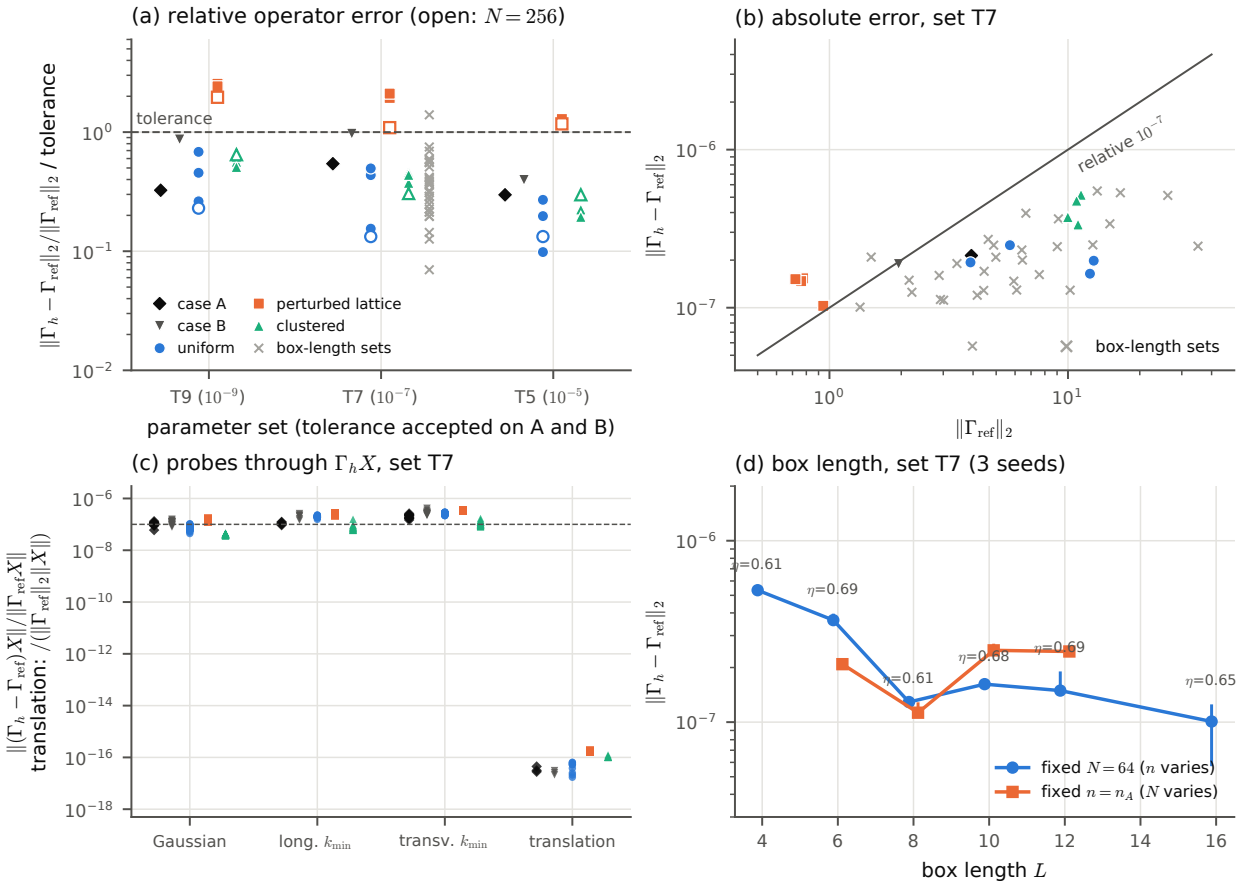


Figure 13: Experiment 1: the production action $X \mapsto \Gamma_h X$ against the unsplit full-periodic reference, $\kappa = 1$, 44 static configurations; one point per configuration, no error bars. (a) Relative spectral error divided by the tolerance for which T9, T7, T5 were accepted on cases A and B (filled: $N \leq 128$; open: $N = 256$; grey crosses: box-length sets, T7 only). (b) Absolute error against $\|\Gamma_{\text{ref}}\|_2$ at T7; diagonal: relative 10^{-7}; crosses: box-length sets. (c) Relative action errors of probes at T7 through the production matvec; translations as operator-normalised residuals. (d) Absolute error against box length at T7, fixed $N = 64$ (density varies) and fixed density n_A; realised η annotated. Source: `exp1_results/figures/exp1_action.pdf` (commit `8777731`).

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